



Investor Positioning and Flows

Rotation Into Tech Still Has Room To Run

A notable feature of equities recently has been a series of rotations, ranges and [sharp catch-up rallies](#), as investors alternate between [the boom and the gloom](#), with [unprecedented earnings growth](#) on the one hand and [battling a slew of negative catalysts and fears](#) on the other.

- In late July, we called for a rotation back into Tech, the 5th in 2 years ([Rotation On Cue, Jul 31 2026](#)). The rotation is now advanced but still has some room to run. MCG & Tech stocks are up 14% since the end of July to a new record high. The rest of the S&P 500 is down -3% since, having sold off -5.5% over the last 5 weeks. The relative outperformance of MCG & Tech has risen to the upper half of its long-run trend channel but is not yet at the top.
- Likewise, positioning in MCG & Tech has risen to about 0.8sd (80th percentile) above neutral, clearly overweight but well below prior peaks such as in early June when it topped out almost 2sd above (99th percentile). Positioning elsewhere is neutral or modestly below, for both defensive and cyclical sectors (with a modest overweight for Energy the exception).
- Overall, large cap equity positioning rose this week and is overweight but not elevated (79th percentile). Systematic strategy positioning has continued to rise and is now in the top decile (91st percentile), and vulnerable to any vol shocks. Discretionary large-cap investor positioning however is only moderately overweight (64th percentile) despite very strong earnings growth, weighed down primarily by the sharp jump in rates volatility. We continue to see [the vol of rates and not their level as key for equities](#).

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Positioning and flows details on page 7

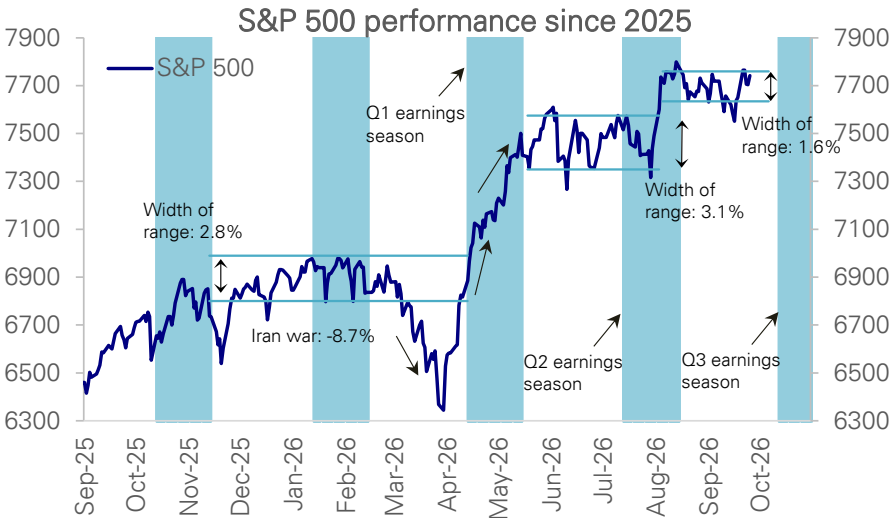
Deutsche Bank Securities Inc.

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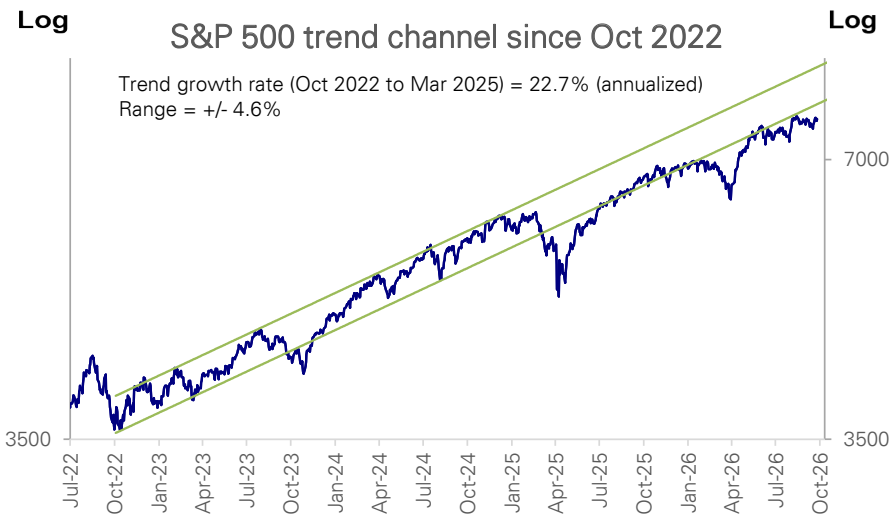
Charts of the Week

Figure 1: The S&P 500 has gone from range-to-range ...



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

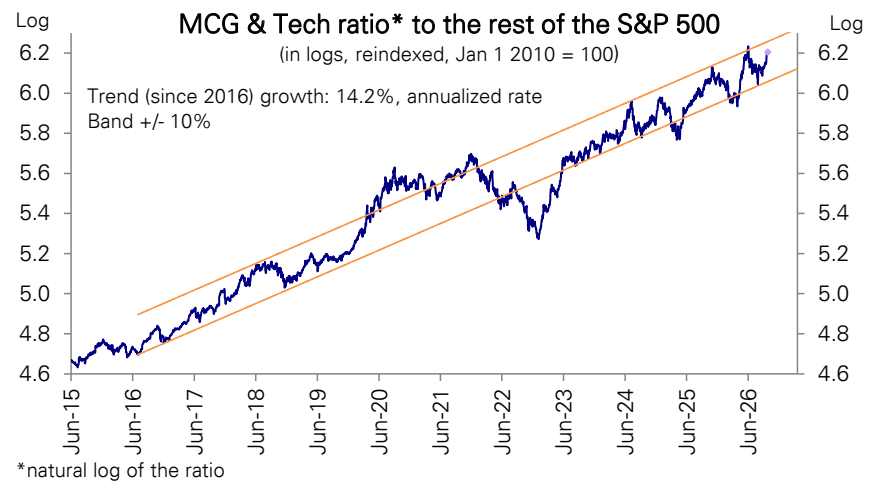
Figure 2: ... with sharp catch-up rallies in between



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

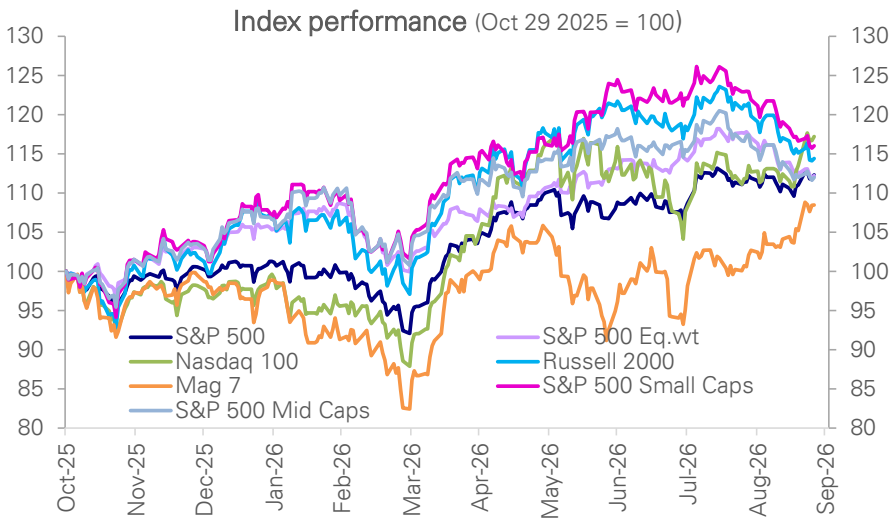


Figure 3: The rotation into Tech that began in late July still has some room to run



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

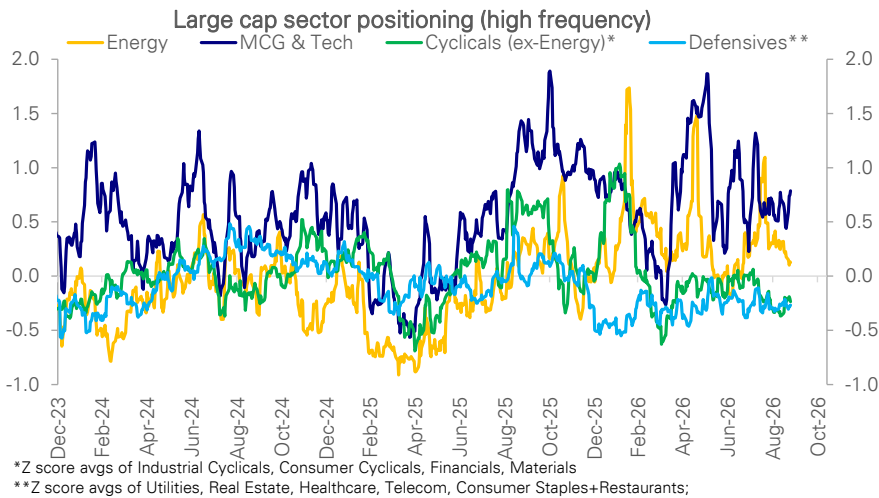
Figure 4: Tech has rallied since then while others have sold off modestly



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

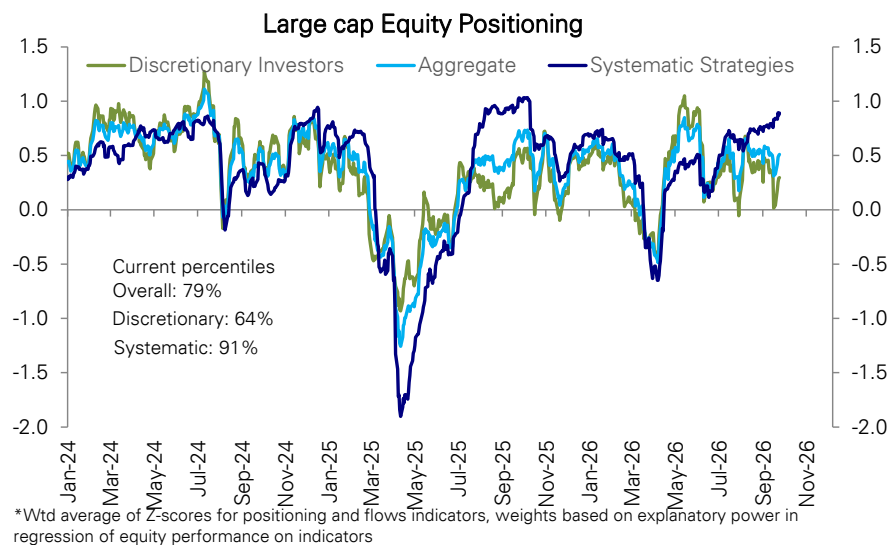


Figure 5: Positioning in MCG & Tech has risen and is clearly overweight but well below prior peaks while that in other sectors is below neutral



Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

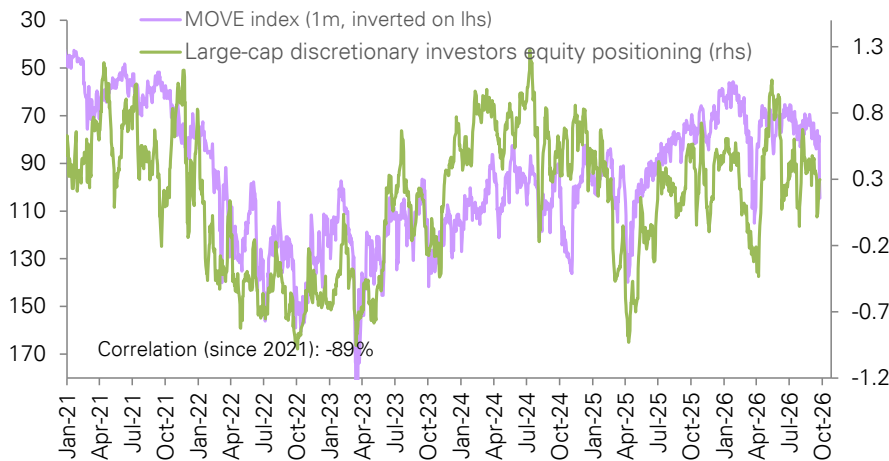
Figure 6: Overall equity positioning is overweight but not elevated as systematic strategies continue to raise exposure to elevated levels but discretionary investors are only moderately overweight



Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



Figure 7: Discretionary investors have been weighted down by rising rates vol



Source : ICE BofA, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



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Positioning and flows detail

- Our measure of **aggregate equity positioning** rose this week to modestly overweight (0.25sd, 58th percentile). **Discretionary investor positioning** (-0.29sd, 28th percentile) jumped from notably underweight to modestly underweight, while **systematic strategies' positioning** (0.91sd, 89th percentile) continued to move higher, marking a new high since Oct 2025. Positioning in **large caps** (0.51sd, 79th percentile) also rose to overweight, while that in **small caps** (-0.13sd, 43rd percentile) declined to slightly underweight.
- Under **discretionary investor positioning**,
 - The **ratio of call-to-put volume** (5d ma) rose sharply this week (90th percentile), driven by a rise in net call volume across single-stock, index, and ETF options. Within single-stock options, volume in MCG & Tech rose sharply, followed by Consumer Cyclical, Industrial Cyclical, and the defensives; volume in Energy declined, while that in Materials and Financials was nominal. **S&P 500 options skew** (3m, 90%-110%) was choppy this week.
 - A **basket of stocks with the highest net call volume in the prior week outperformed** the broader market this week, while a **basket of the most shorted stocks** performed in line with the market.
 - **Investor sentiment** (bull minus bear spread) rose this week and turned less bearish (12th percentile). Bullish responses (33rd percentile) and neutral responses (7th percentile) increased, while bearish responses (94th percentile) declined.
- Under **systematic strategies' positioning**,
 - **Vol control funds'** equity allocation increased this week and remains elevated (98th percentile). Sensitivity to selloffs also increased, making funds somewhat more responsive to downside moves than in the prior week. With positioning still stretched, capacity for further equity addition remains limited, while the flow backdrop has become modestly less supportive during market drawdowns.
 - **CTAs'** equity positioning edged up slightly (82nd percentile). Positioning increased across regions, with the US (90th percentile), Europe (85th percentile), EM (75th percentile), and Japan (62nd percentile) all moving higher. Further increases in equity exposure are still likely to depend more on declining volatility than on stronger trend signals. Across other asset classes, bond shorts remain extreme (US 10th percentile, Europe 11th percentile), while dollar longs increased sharply (89th percentile). In commodities, positioning in gold remains short (14th percentile), while that in copper (98th percentile) and oil (78th percentile) remains very long.
 - **Risk parity funds'** equity allocations declined this week but continue to be elevated (77th percentile). Exposure remains strongest in the US (82nd percentile) and developed markets ex-US (78th percentile), while in EM remains modestly conservative (67th percentile). At the same time, bond allocations remain below historical norms (30th percentile). Exposures to commodities (95th percentile), REITs (95th percentile), and broader inflation-hedges (91st percentile) remain elevated. Overall, risk parity funds shifted slightly from equities toward bonds this week, while maintaining allocation to inflation-sensitive assets and retaining room to increase equity exposure.
- **Across sectors, positioning is overweight MCG & Tech and modestly**



overweight Energy. MCG & Tech (0.79sd, 80th percentile) jumped to notably overweight again, while Energy (0.13sd, 73rd percentile) was pared further to slightly overweight. Other cyclicals remained modestly underweight. Consumer Cyclicals (-0.20sd, 61st percentile) remained flat, Industrial Cyclicals (-0.20sd, 43rd percentile) and Financials (-0.30sd, 29th percentile) declined modestly, and Materials (-0.25sd, 22nd percentile) rose. Among defensives, Healthcare (0.02sd, 53rd percentile) and Consumer Staples (-0.03sd, 30th percentile) rose to neutral this week. Real Estate (-0.34sd, 44th percentile) declined sharply to underweight, while Utilities (-0.53sd, 18th percentile) remained underweight.

- **Weekly fund flows to ETFs and mutual funds:** Equity funds (-\$10.2bn) recorded their first weekly outflows in three months, while inflows to bond funds (\$17.3bn) picked up after slowing last week. Money market funds (\$11.6bn) also attracted inflows.
 - **Equity funds** (-\$10.2bn) recorded their first outflows in three months, driven primarily by the largest outflows from the US (-\$21.2bn) in six months. In contrast, inflows to broad-global funds (\$13.3bn) remained robust, for a sixth straight month. Japan (\$0.3bn) received small inflows, while Europe (-\$0.4bn) saw modest outflows for a second consecutive week. EM (-\$3.9bn) registered outflows, largely driven by Asia ex-Japan (-\$3.6bn), particularly China (-\$2.4bn), India (-\$0.7bn), and Korea (-\$0.3bn). Broad EM (-\$0.7bn) also suffered outflows, while Latam (\$0.1bn) and EMEA (\$0.4bn) received modest inflows.
 - Among **dedicated sector funds**, Financials (-\$2.5bn) saw their biggest weekly outflows in six months, while Tech (-\$1.9bn) and Industrials (-\$1.0bn) also experienced notable outflows. Real Estate (-\$0.6bn), Healthcare (-\$0.4bn), Utilities (-\$0.2bn), and Materials (-\$0.1bn) saw modest outflows, while Telecom (\$0.4bn) and Energy (\$0.1bn) received modest inflows. Flows to Consumer Goods were muted.
 - Inflows to **bond funds** (\$17.3bn) picked up from last week. Inflows to broad-mandate funds (\$6.4bn) rose to a three-week high, while Government bonds (\$2.4bn) received their smallest inflows in three months. IG (\$2.0bn) received inflows, while HY saw only muted flows this week. EM bonds (\$4.7bn) continued to attract steady inflows, that reached their highest in four months. Bank loans (\$1.7bn) received their largest inflows since Feb 2025. Munis (\$1.1bn) and TIPS (\$0.4bn) also received inflows, while MBS (-\$1.3bn) posted their first outflows since Apr.
 - **Money market funds** (\$11.6bn) received inflows this week, driven by the US (\$17.2bn), while Japan (-\$1.3bn) and Europe (-\$0.9bn) saw modest outflows.



DB S&P 500 Forecasts

DB S&P 500 forecasts	
S&P 500 2026 target	8000
S&P 500 2026 EPS	\$358
S&P 500 2027 EPS	\$420

Our Recent Publications

Investor Positioning And Flows

- [Discretionary Investors Very Cautious Already - Sep 18 2026](#)
- [Battling Multiple Catalysts - Sep 11 2026](#)
- [Chopping In A Tight Range – Sep 4 2026](#)
- [Sideways At Modestly Overweight - Aug 28 2026](#)
- [Another Post-Earnings-Season Lull - Aug 21 2026](#)
- [Chart Pack – Aug 14 2026](#)
- [Another Sharp Catch Up Rally – Aug 7 2026](#)
- [Rotating On Cue Again – Jul 31 2026](#)
- [The Boom And The Gloom - Jul 24](#)
- [Three Divergences - Jul 17 2026](#)

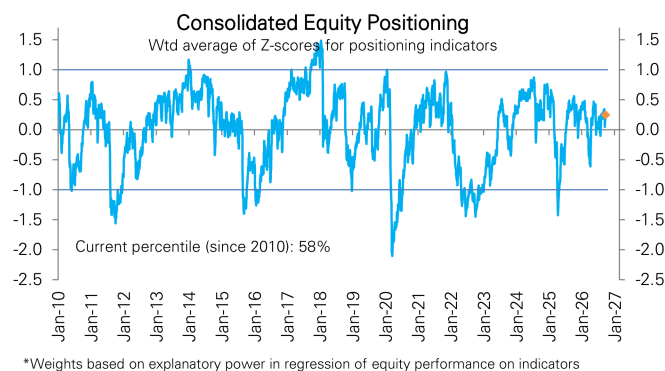
Asset Allocation

- [Looking Out To Year End: Still Constructive - Sep 18 2026](#)
- [Q2 2026 Global Earnings Takes: Big Beats And Raises As Growth Accelerates - Aug 7 2026](#)
- [What Companies Are Saying: The Boom Is Much Broader Than AI - Aug 7 2026](#)
- [Q2 2026 Earnings: Broad Based Acceleration - Jul 31 2026](#)
- [Q2 2026 Earnings: Looking For Growth In The High 20s - Jun 30 2026](#)
- [Is The Surge In Capex Crowding Out Buybacks? Jun 23 2026](#)
- [What Companies Are Saying: Time To Stop Calling Them Shocks? - May 14 2026](#)
- [Q1 2026 Global Earnings: Tech Drives Robust Growth - May 11 2026](#)
- [Q1 Earnings Takes: A Sharp Acceleration, Raising Estimates - May 04 2026](#)
- [Q1 2026 Earnings: Looking For A Four-Year High In Growth But Modest Beats - Apr 8 2026](#)



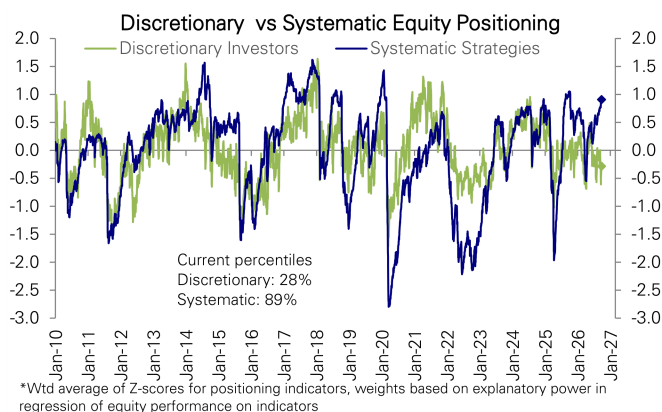
Consolidated Equity Positioning

Figure 8: Consolidated equity positioning¹



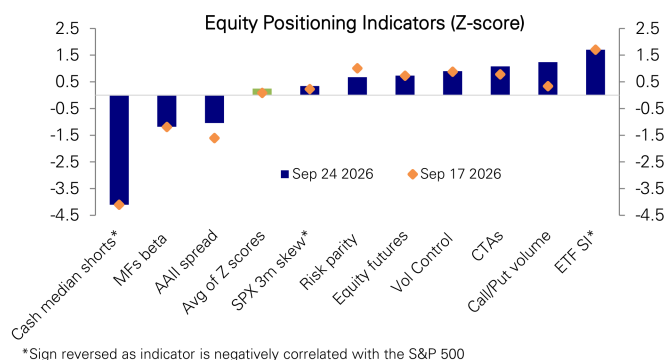
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 9: Discretionary vs systematic strategies divide²



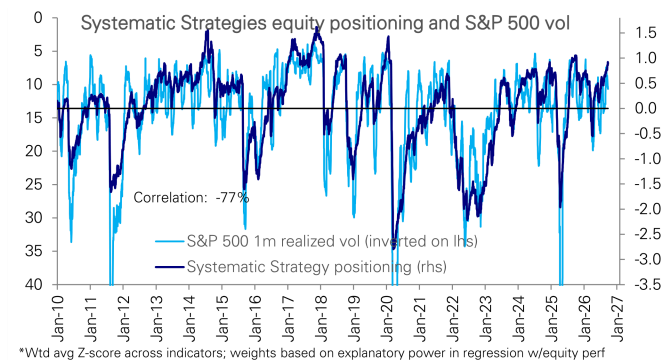
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 10: All equity positioning indicators



Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 11: Systematic strategies positioning vs S&P 500 realized volatility



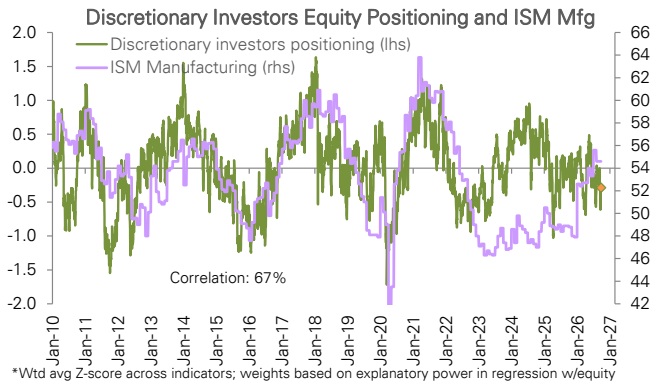
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

- Equity positioning indicators include: CTA portfolio weight, Risk-Parity portfolio weight, Vol control allocation, active MF beta, AAll Bull-Bear spread, cash equity median shorts, ETF short interest, equity futures positions, Call/Put volume, S&P 500 option skew. More details can be found in [Appendix](#)
- Systematic strategy indicators: CTA portfolio weight, Risk-Parity portfolio weight, Vol control allocation, equity futures positions; Discretionary indicators: Active MF beta, AAll Bull-Bear spread, cash equity median shorts, ETF short interest, equity futures positions, Call/Put volume, S&P 500 option skew



Investor Positioning and Flows

Figure 12: Discretionary investor positioning vs ISM Manufacturing



Source : ISM, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

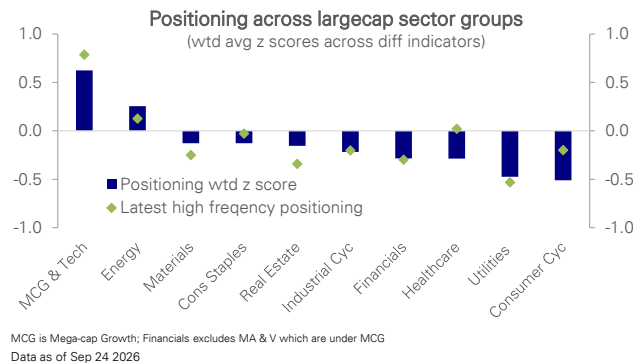
Figure 13: Discretionary investor positioning vs S&P 500 earnings growth



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

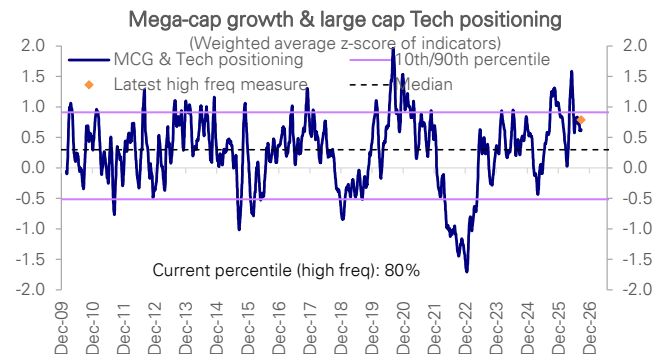
Sector Positioning

Note: We have modified our sector metrics to focus on large cap indices

Figure 14: Equity positioning across large-cap sectors³

Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 15: Mega-cap growth & large cap Tech positioning

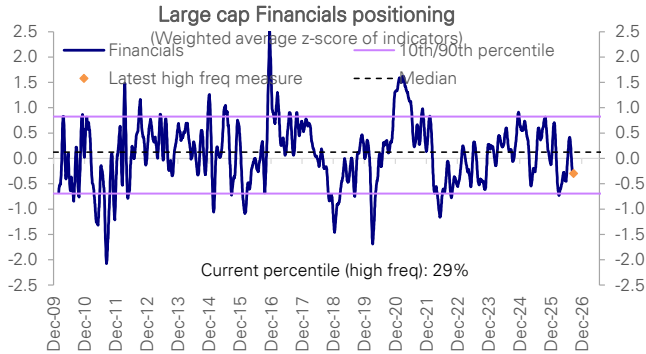


Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

³ Sector positioning indicator includes: Wtd Call/Put volume, S&P 500 cash shorts as % of mkt cap, sector fund flows, active MF excess return correlation and Sell-side analyst consensus targets. More details can be found in the [Appendix](#)

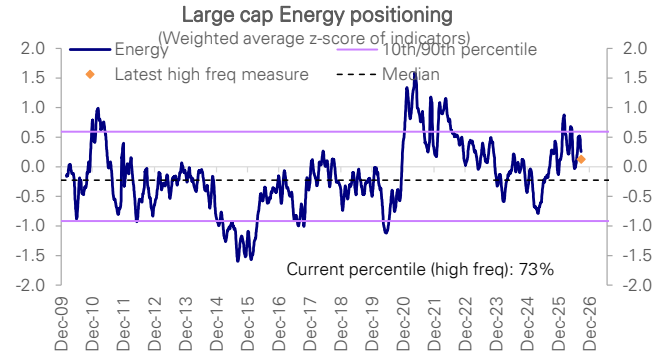


Figure 16: Large-cap Financials positioning



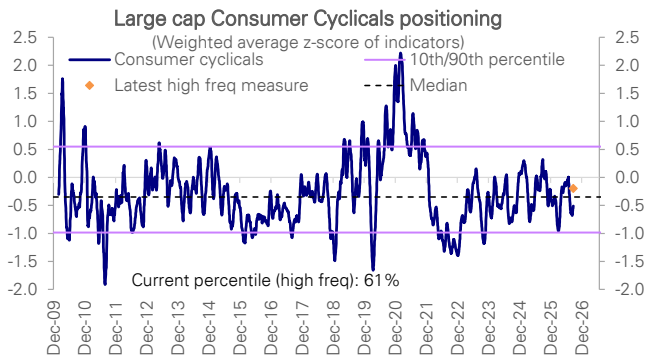
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 17: Large-cap Energy positioning



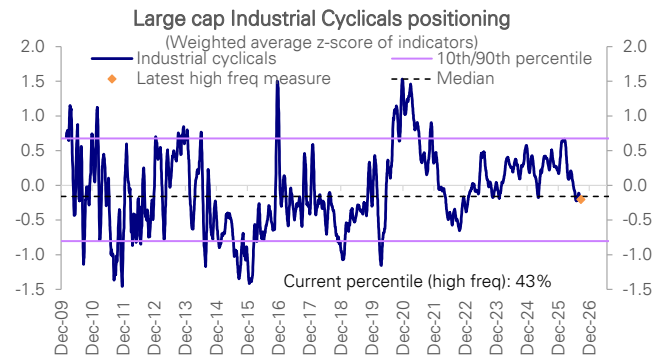
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 18: Large-cap Consumer cyclicals positioning



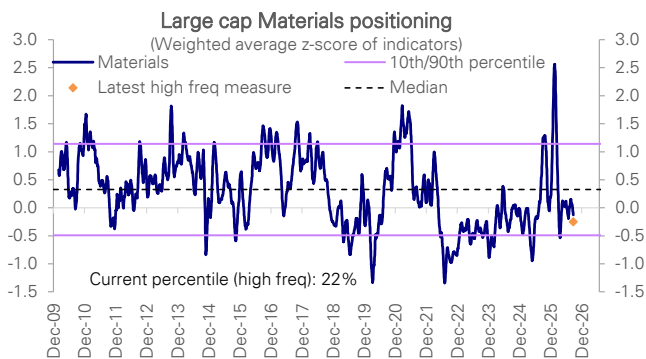
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 19: Large-cap Industrial cyclicals positioning



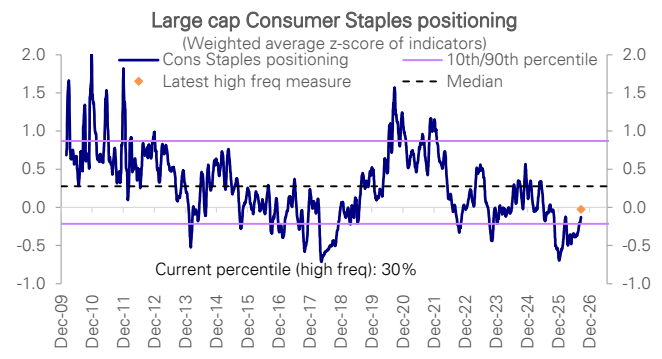
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 20: Large-cap Materials positioning



Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 21: Large-cap Consumer Staples positioning

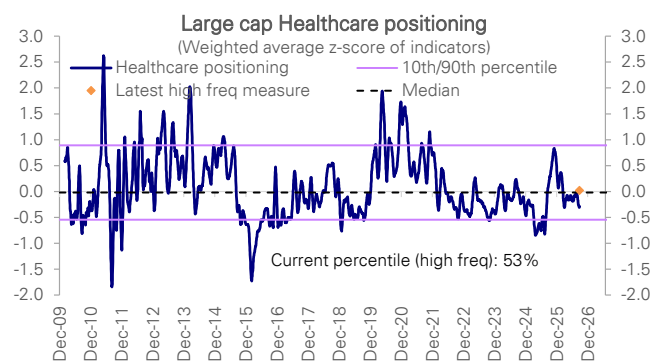


Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



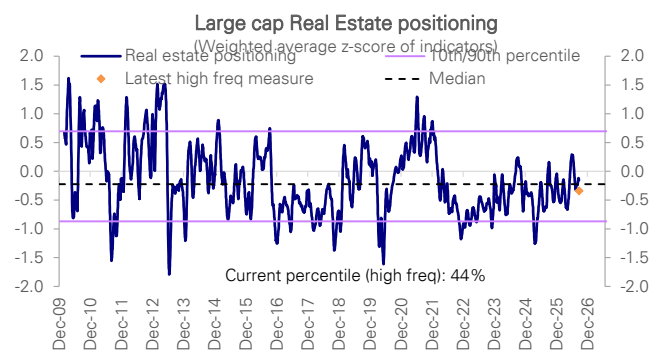
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Figure 22: Large-cap Healthcare positioning



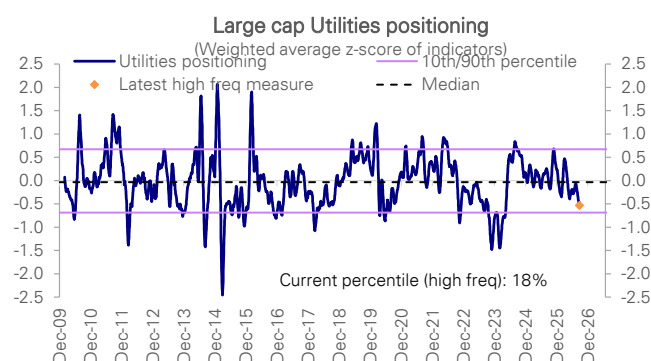
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 23: Large-cap Real Estate positioning



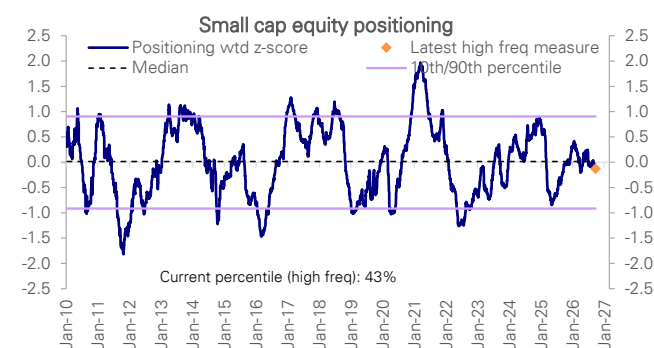
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 24: Large-cap Utilities positioning



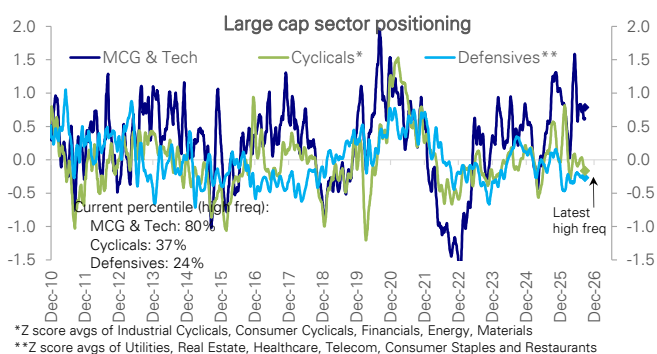
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 25: Small-cap positioning



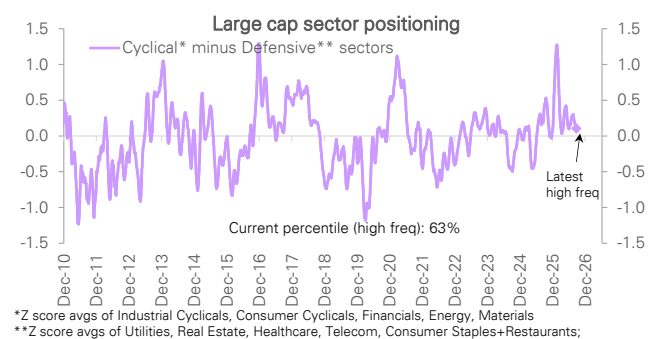
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 26: Major sector groups positioning



Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 27: Cyclical minus defensives positioning



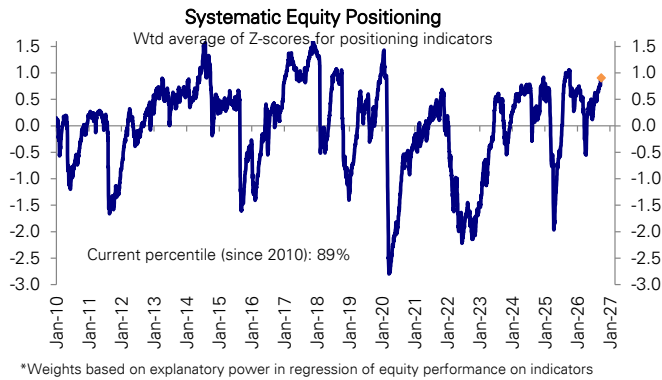
Source : Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



Volatility-Sensitive Systematic Strategies ⁴

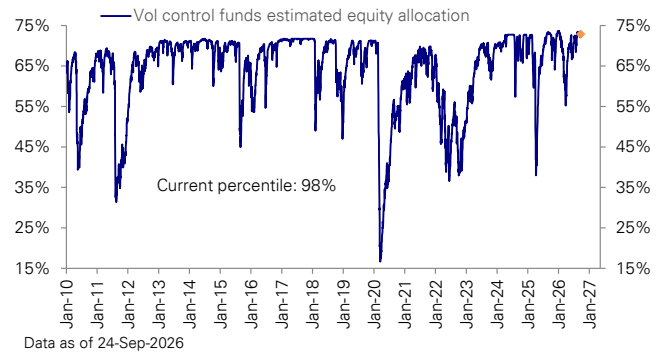
Systematic strategies equity positioning

Figure 28: Systematic strategies positioning



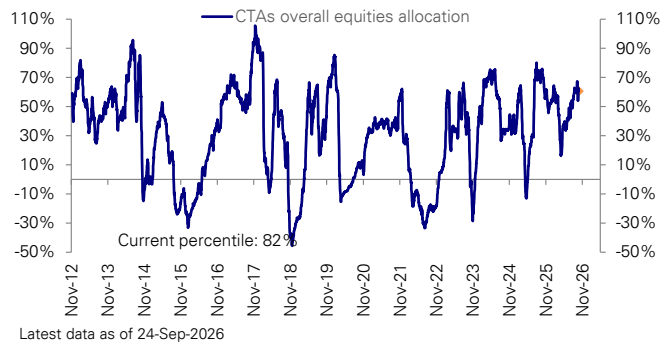
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 29: Vol-Control equity allocations



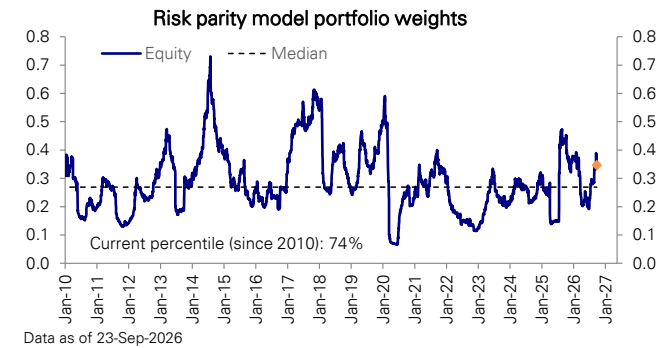
Source : SEC filings, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 30: CTAs exposure to equities



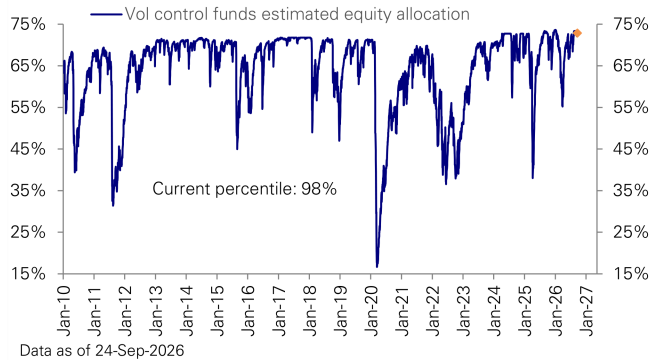
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 31: Risk-Parity portfolio weight in equity



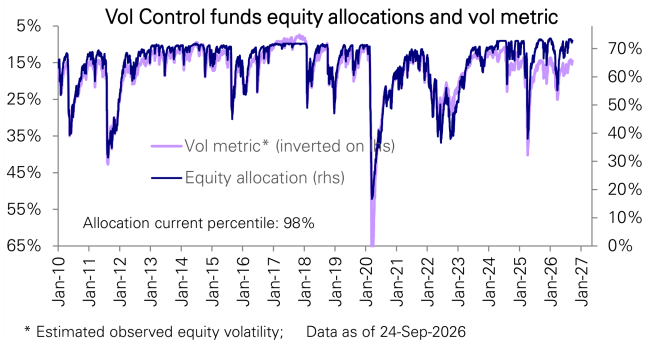
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

⁴ More details can be found in [Appendix](#)

Vol-Control funds allocations⁵Figure 32: Vol-Control funds equity allocations⁶

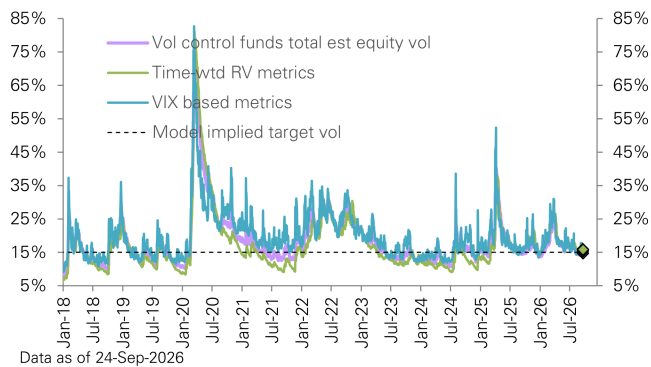
Source : SEC filings, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 33: Vol-Control funds equity allocation and estimated observed equity volatility



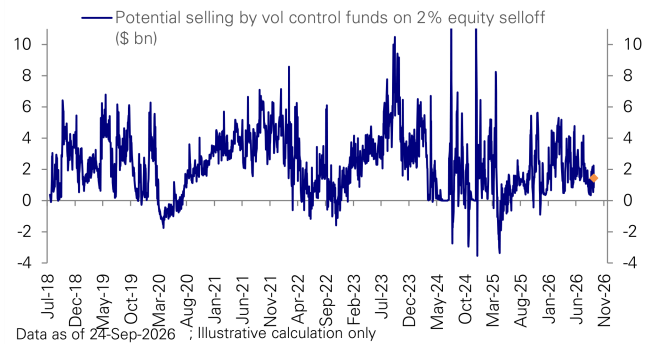
Source : SEC filings, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 34: Vol metrics breakdown



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 35: Vol-Control funds sensitivity to a 2% market sell-off



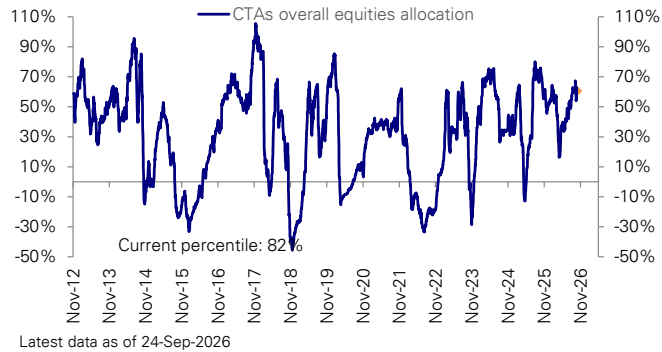
Source : SEC filings, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

⁵ In mid-September 2025, our model was recalibrated to include funds allocation data extending through Q1 2025

⁶ Vol funds total equity allocation tries to mimic the equity rebalancing behavior of a sample of 25 Vol funds following a constant target volatility strategy.

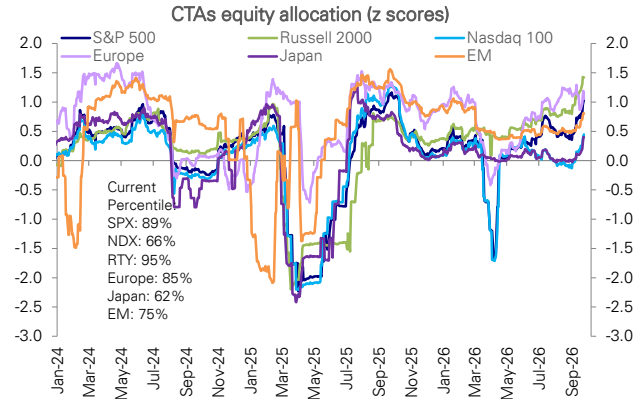
CTA portfolio weights⁷

Figure 36: CTAs exposure to equities



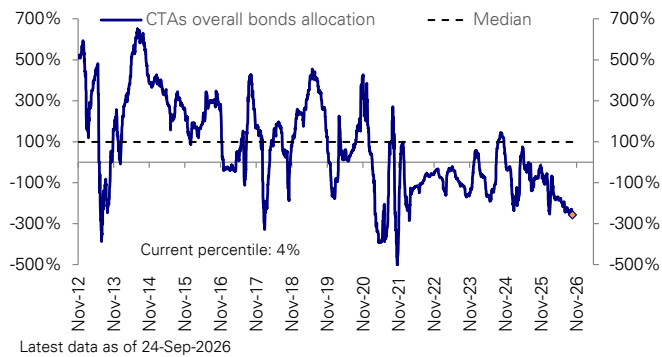
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 37: CTAs exposure to equity categories (z scores)



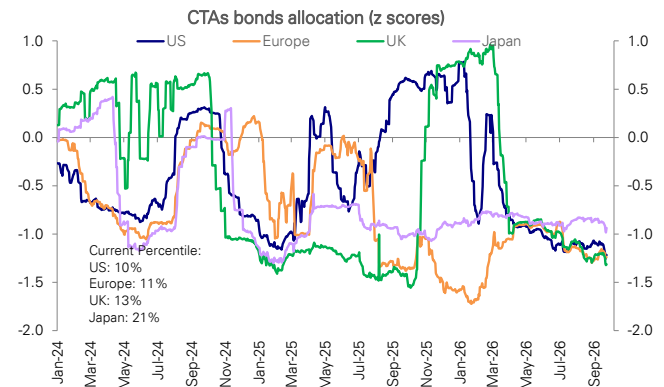
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 38: CTAs exposure to bonds



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 39: CTAs exposure to bond regions (z scores)



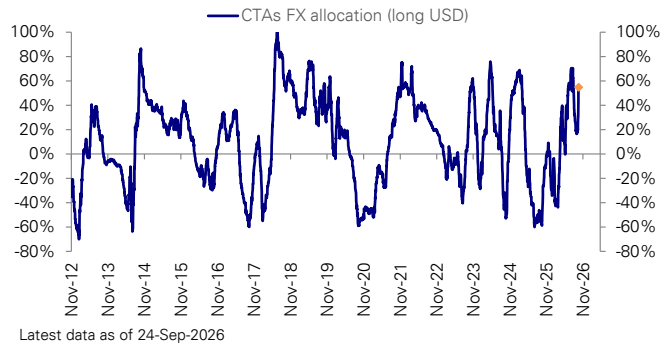
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

⁷ These are model-based portfolio weights, and take into account for each asset class the momentum trend signal, volatility, and cross-asset correlations. The model is designed to follow movements in CTA benchmark indices.



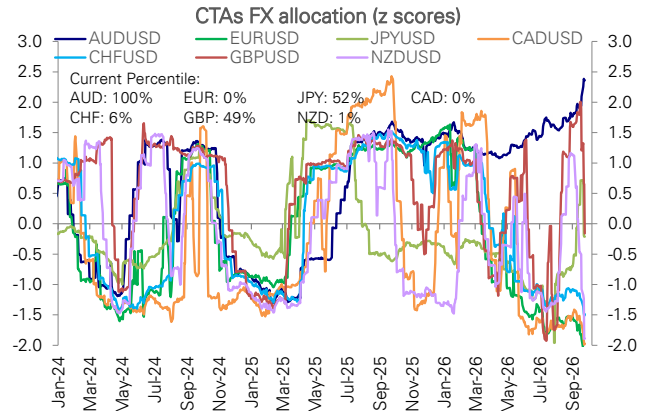
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Figure 40: CTAs exposure to the US dollar



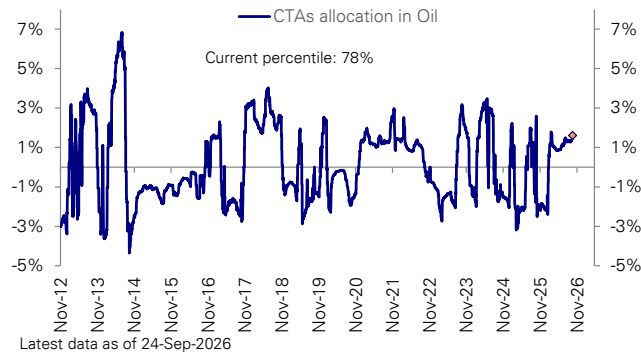
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 41: CTAs exposure to Currencies (z-scores)



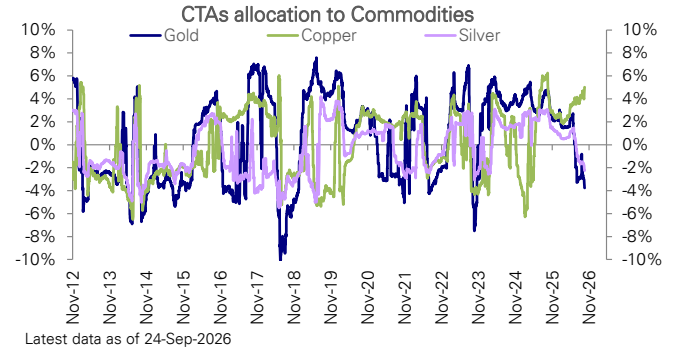
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 42: CTAs exposure to Oil



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 43: CTAs exposure to major Commodities

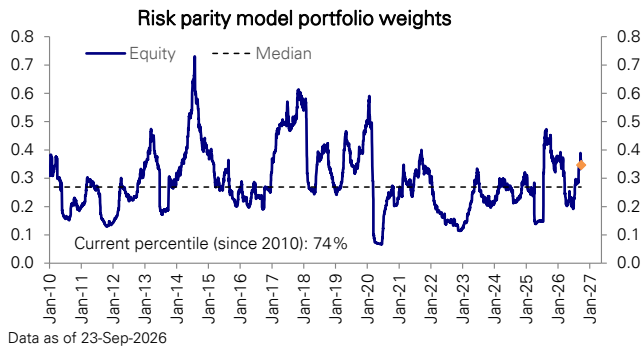


Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



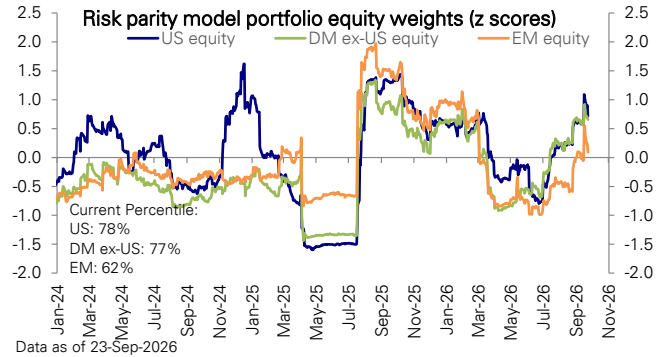
Risk-Parity funds portfolio weights ⁸

Figure 44: Risk-Parity portfolio weight in equity



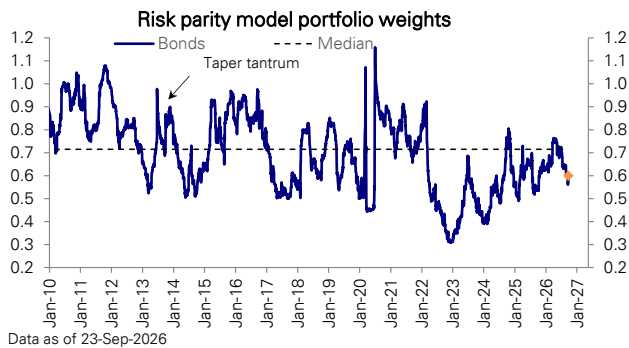
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 45: Risk-Parity portfolio weight in equity regions (z scores)



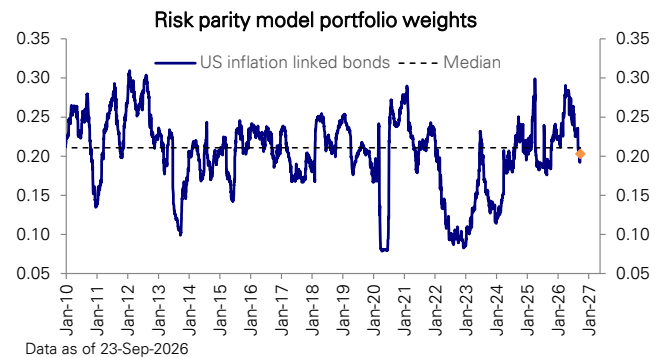
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 46: Risk-Parity portfolio weight in bonds



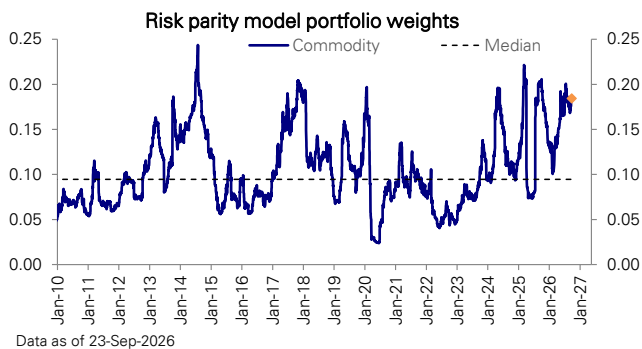
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 47: Risk-Parity portfolio weight in US inflation-linked bonds



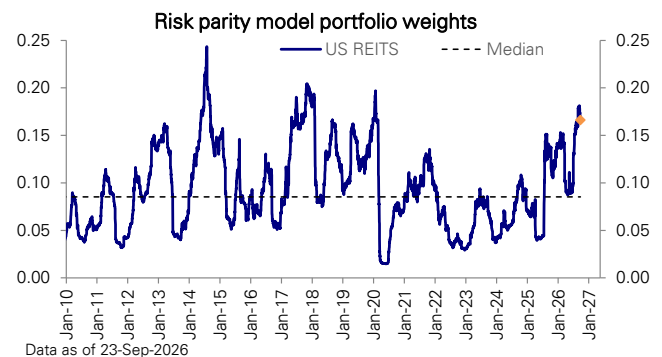
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 48: Risk-Parity portfolio weight in Commodities



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 49: Risk-Parity portfolio weight in US REITs



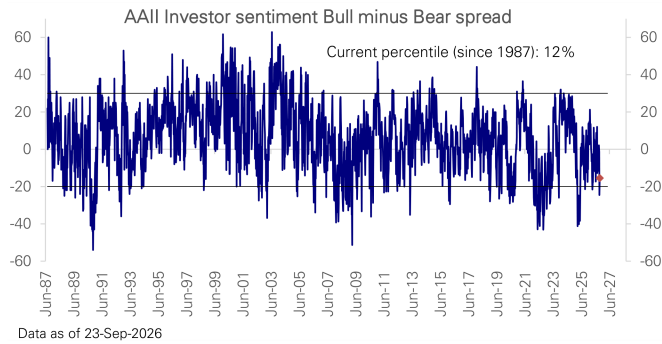
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

⁸ These are our model-based portfolio weights calculated to balance the risk contribution across different asset classes (equities, bonds, commodities), using volatility and cross-asset correlations. The model is designed to follow movements in risk-parity benchmark indices



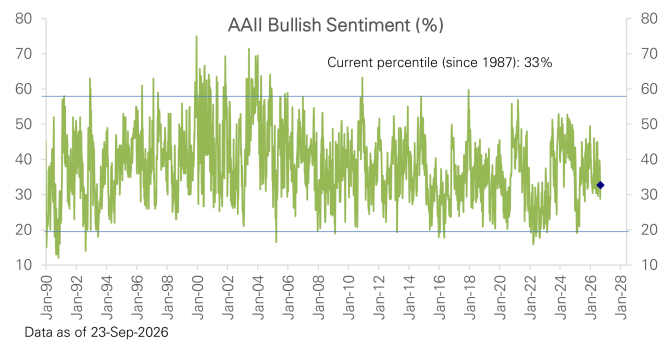
Investor Sentiment

Figure 50: Investor bull minus bear spread ⁹



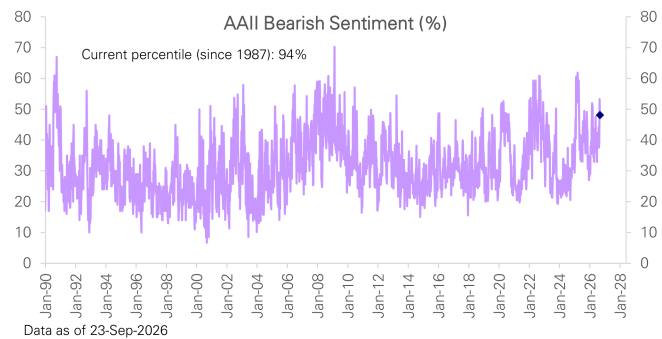
Source : Barron's, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 51: Investor bullish sentiment



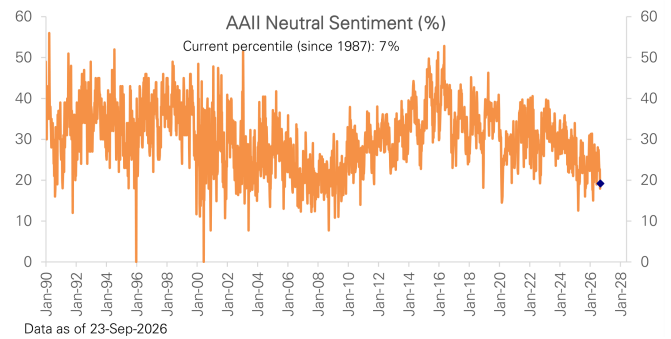
Source : Barron's, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 52: Investor bearish sentiment



Source : Barron's, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 53: Investor neutral sentiment



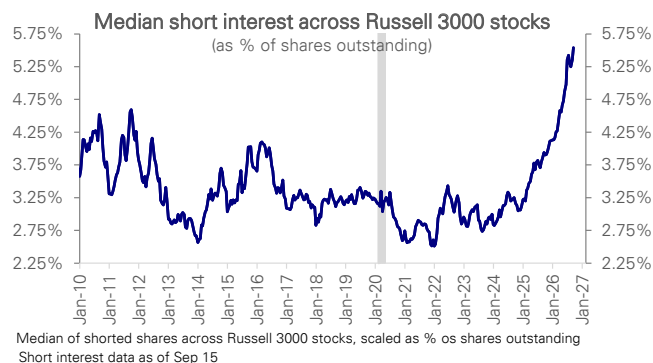
Source : Barron's, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

⁹ Investor sentiment (Bull minus Bear spread) from the AAll Investor Sentiment Survey.



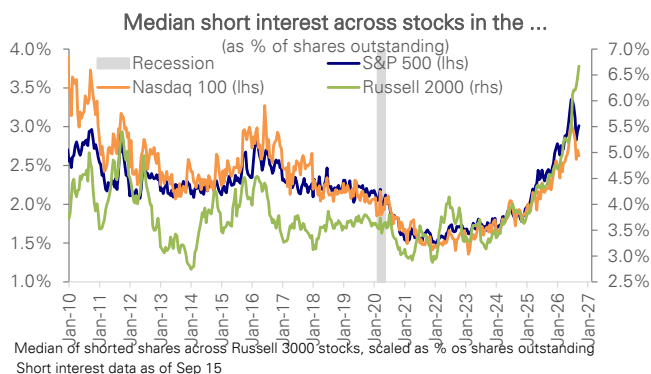
Equity Short Interest

Figure 54: Median cash shorts taken as % of shares outstanding for the Russell 3000¹⁰



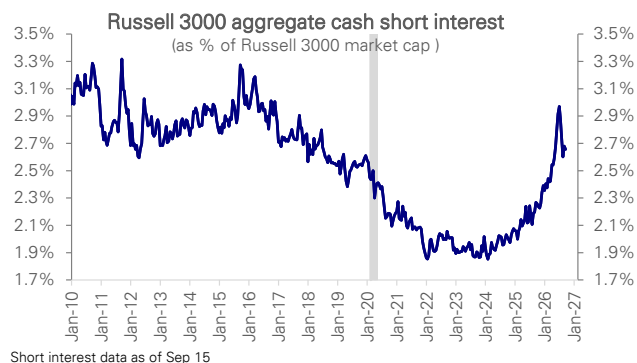
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 55: Median cash shorts taken as % of shares outstanding for the S&P 500, Russell 2000 and Nasdaq 100



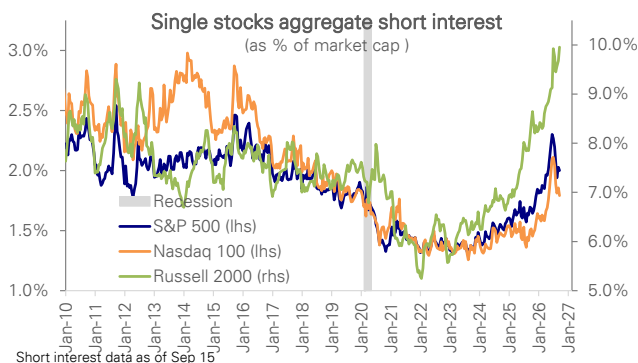
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 56: Cash equities short interest as % of market cap¹¹



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 57: Cash equities short interest across indices as % of market cap¹²



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

10 Median of each companies' shorted shares taken as % of total shares outstanding across the Russell 3000 universe

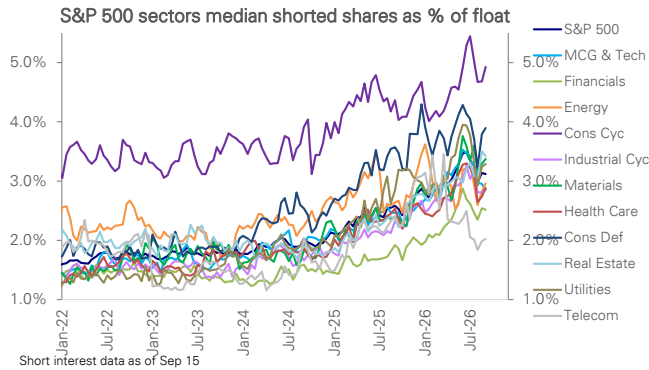
11 Single stocks short interest aggregate (price*shorted shares) across the Russell 3000 universe, taken as % of overall Russell 3000 market cap.

12 Single stocks short interest aggregate (price*shorted shares), taken as % of market cap for indices



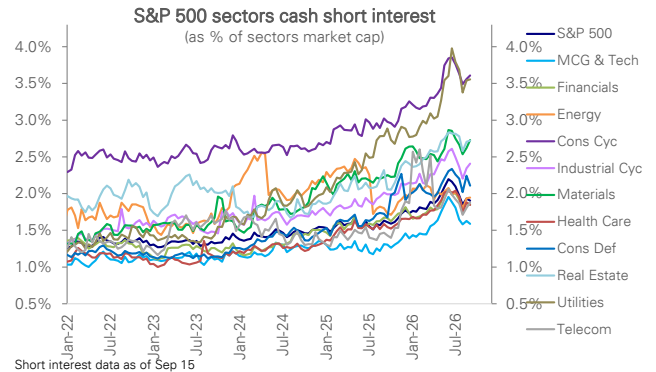
Investor Positioning and Flows

Figure 58: S&P 500 sectors median cash shorts taken as % of shares outstanding



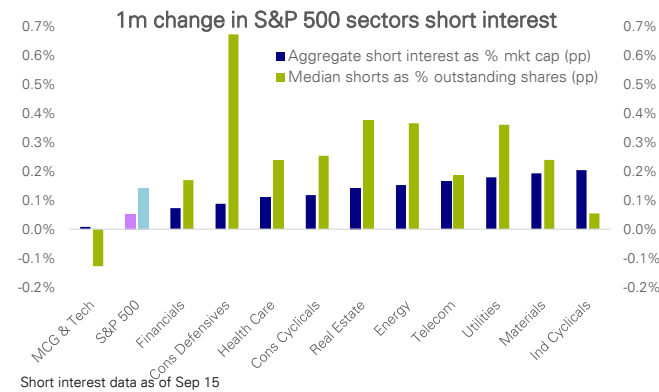
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 59: S&P 500 sectors cash equities short interest as % of market cap



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 60: 1-month change in sector-wise short interest



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 61: Short interest basket relative performance

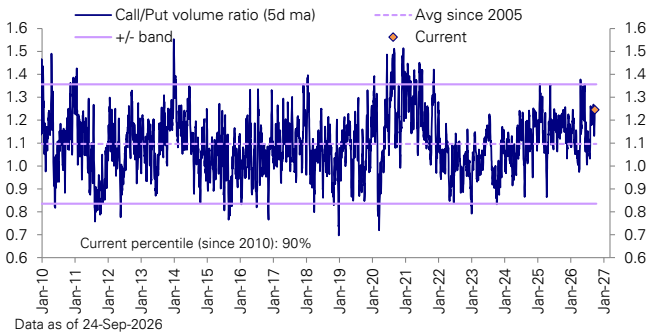


Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



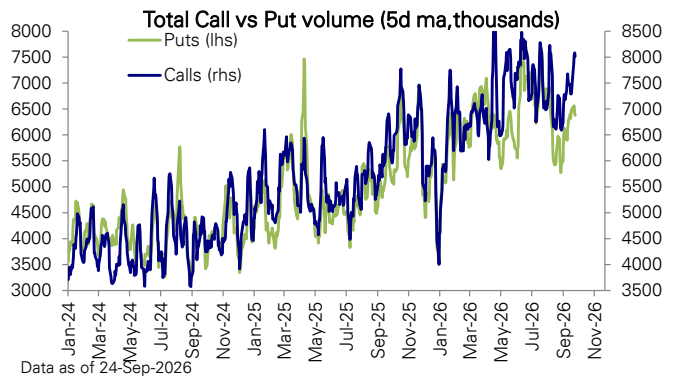
Option Metrics

Figure 62: Equity call/put volume ratio ¹³



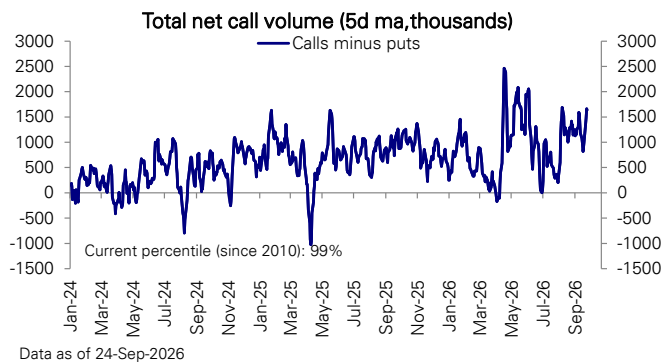
Source : CBOE, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 63: Equity call vs put volumes



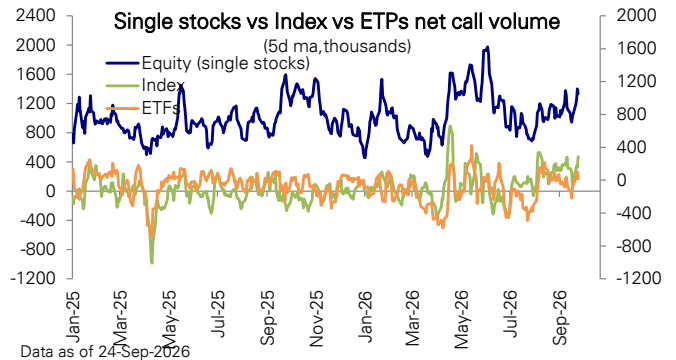
Source : CBOE, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 64: Total net call volume



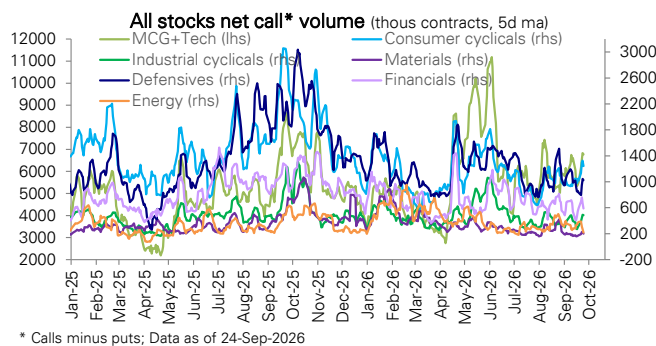
Source : CBOE, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 65: Net call volume of single stocks, Index and ETFs



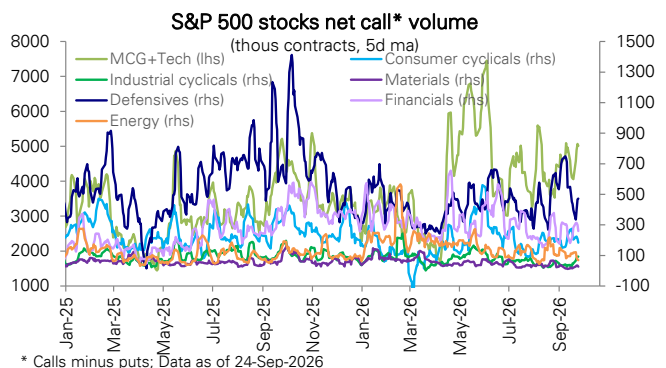
Source : CBOE, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 66: All stocks net call volume across sector groups



Source : OCC, Axioma, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 67: S&P 500 stocks net call volume across sector groups

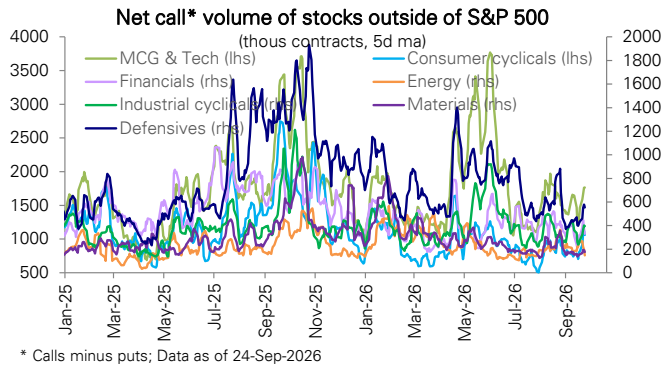


Source : OCC, Axioma, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

¹³ Call/Put volume ratio (5d ma): 5-day rolling average of the ratio of total call volume to total put volume across single stocks, indices and ETPs.

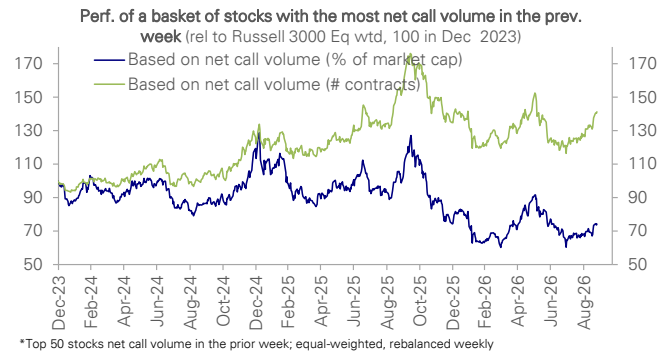


Figure 68: Net call volume of stocks outside of the S&P 500 across sector groups



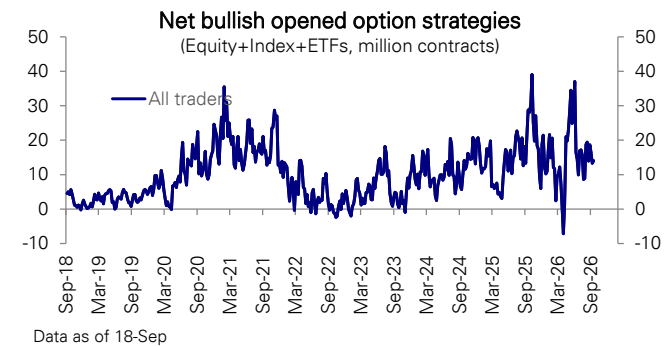
Source : OCC, Axioma, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 69: Relative performance of a basket of stocks with the highest call volume in the previous week



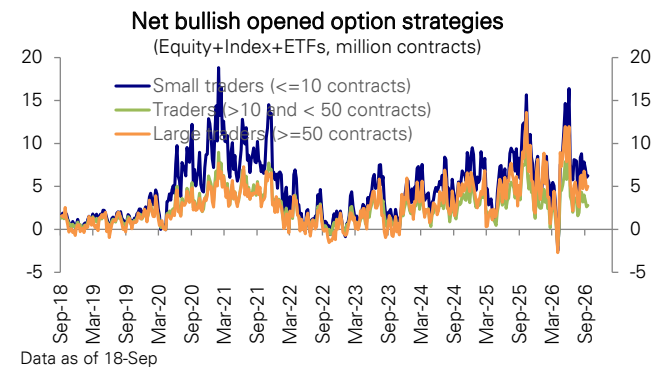
Source : OCC, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 70: Net bullish opened option volume for all customers ¹⁴



Source : OCC, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 71: Net bullish opened option volume by customer category



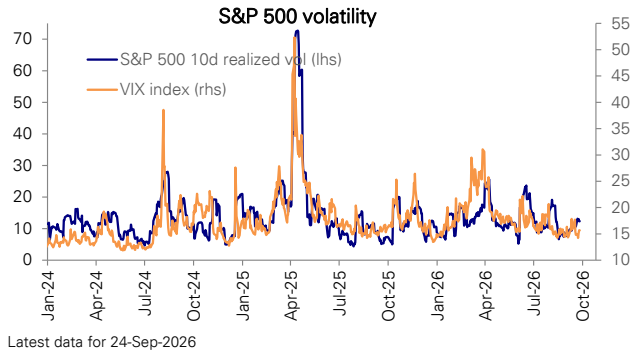
Source : OCC, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

¹⁴ Net Bullish Opened option volumes: Difference between newly opened aggregate bullish contracts (buying a new Call or writing a Put) minus newly opened aggregate bearish contracts (buying a new Put or writing a Call).



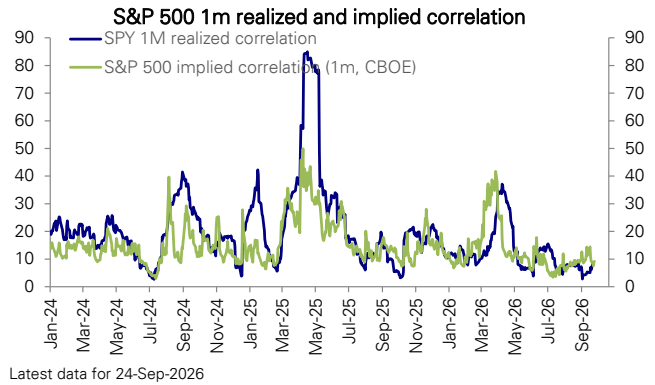
S&P 500 Options: Vol, Skew, Correlation

Figure 72: S&P 500 realized and implied volatility



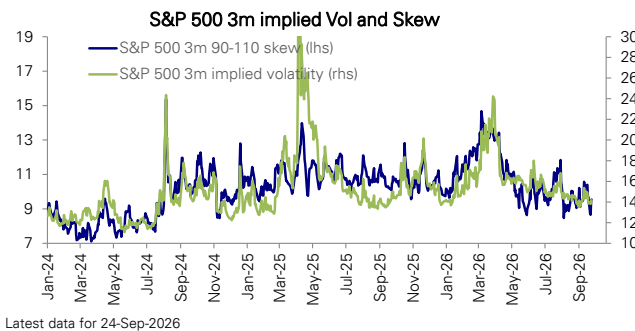
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 73: S&P 500 1m realized and implied correlation



Source : CBOE, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

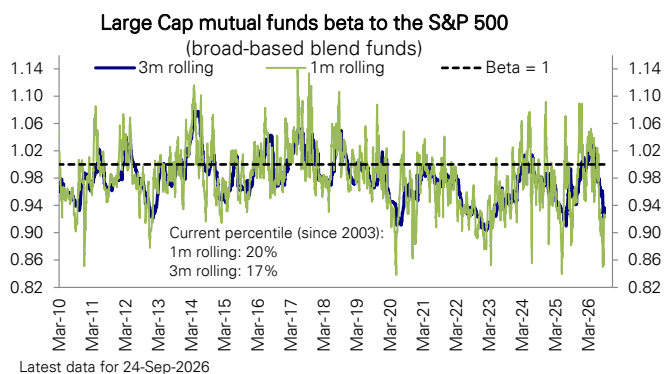
Figure 74: 3M implied vol and skew



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

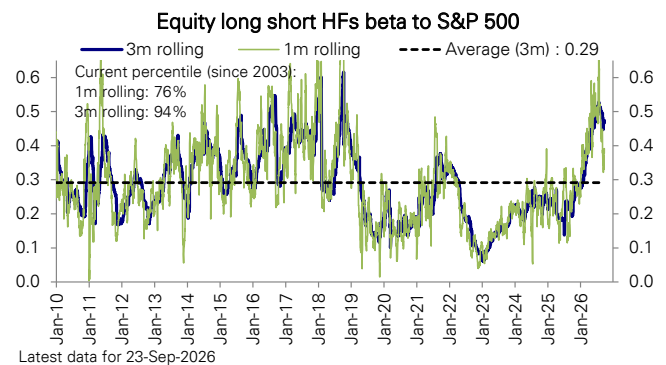
Equity funds beta to the S&P 500¹⁵

Figure 75: Blended mutual funds beta to the S&P 500



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 76: Equity L/S HFs beta to the S&P 500



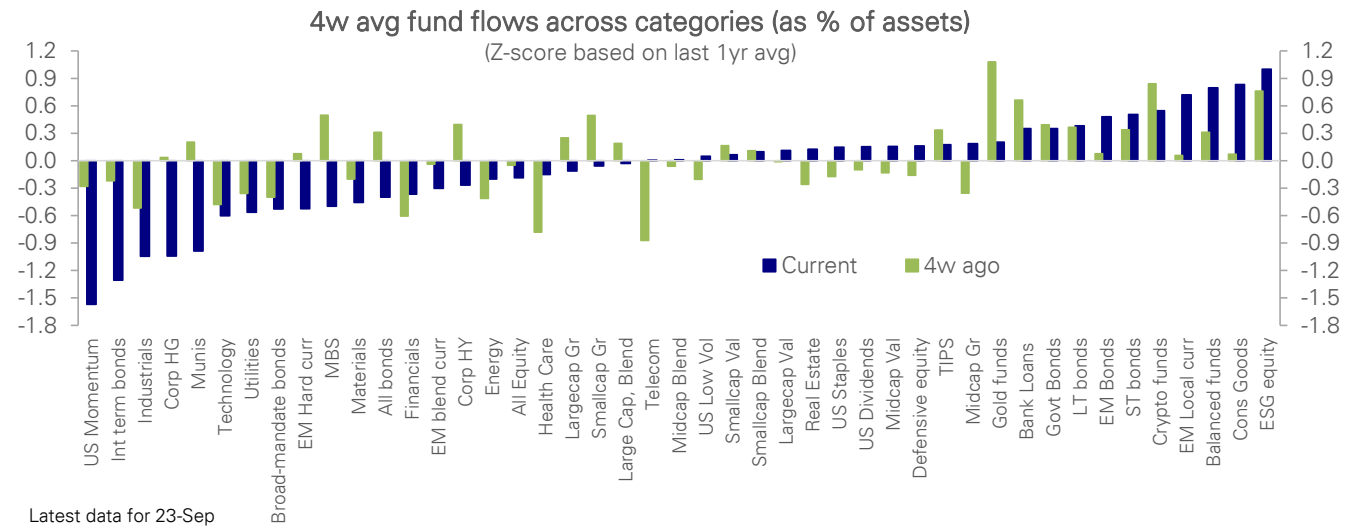
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

¹⁵ Equity mutual funds and L/S Hedge Index (HFRXEH) rolling 1-month and 3-month beta to SPX.



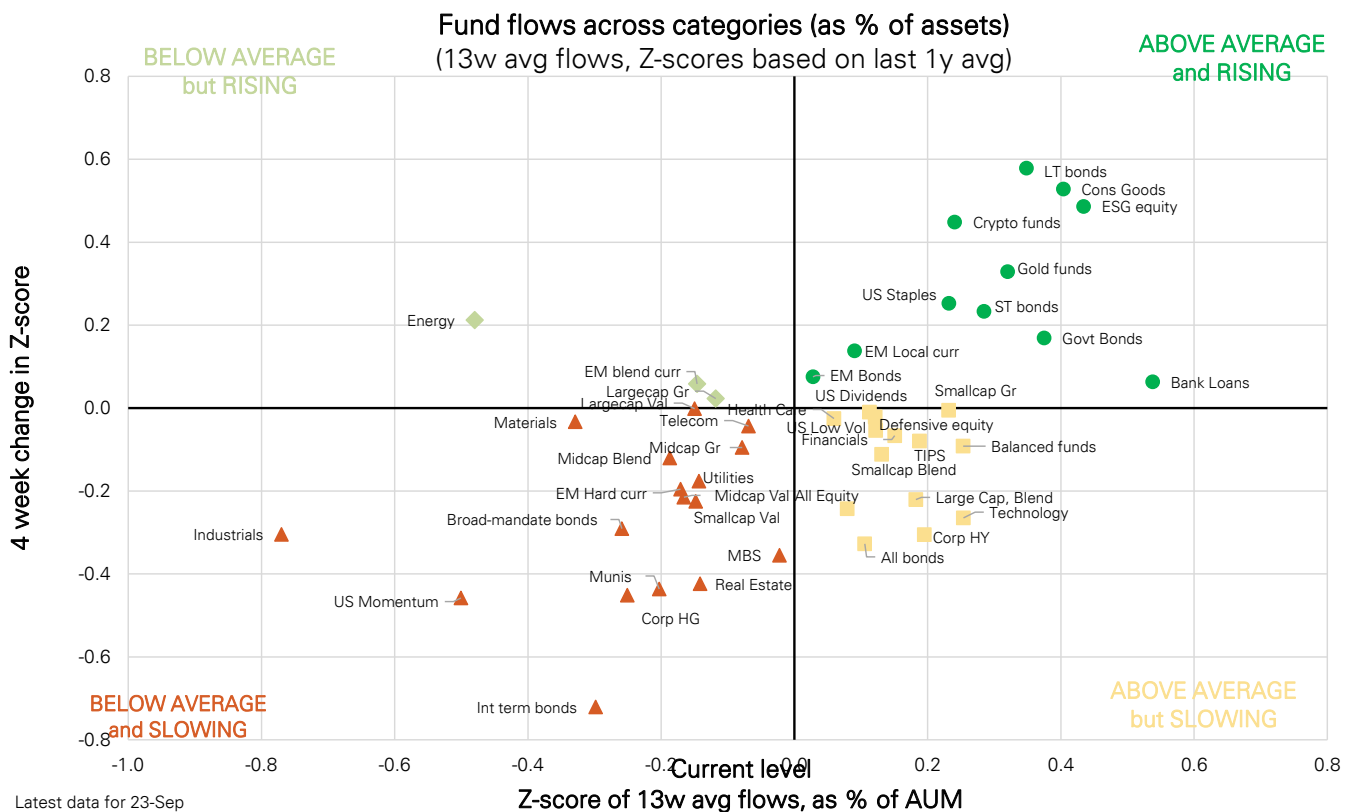
Cross-Asset Fund Flows

Figure 77: Summary of fund flows across assets and categories



Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 78: Recent trends in fund flows across asset classes and categories

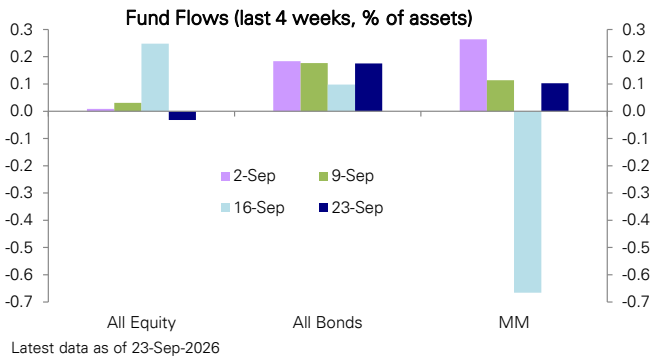


Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



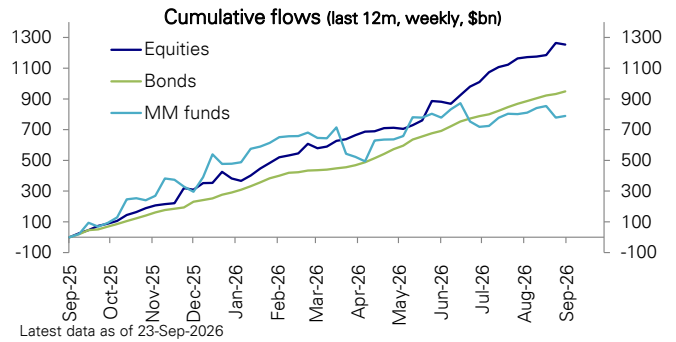
Investor Positioning and Flows

Figure 79: Flows across major asset classes last 4 weeks



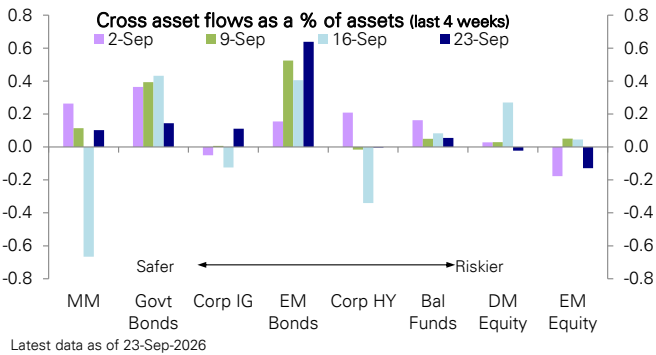
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 80: Flows across major asset classes in last 12 months



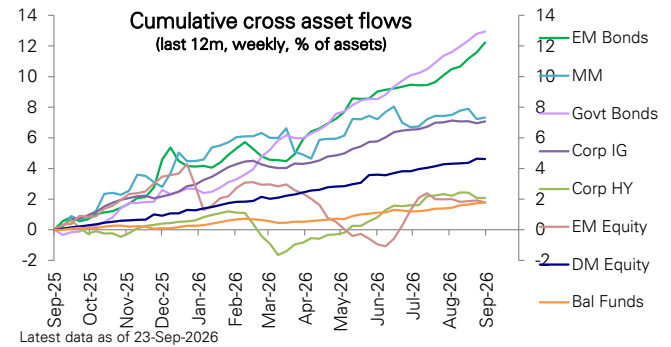
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 81: Cross-asset flows last 4 weeks



Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 82: Cross-asset flows in last 12 months

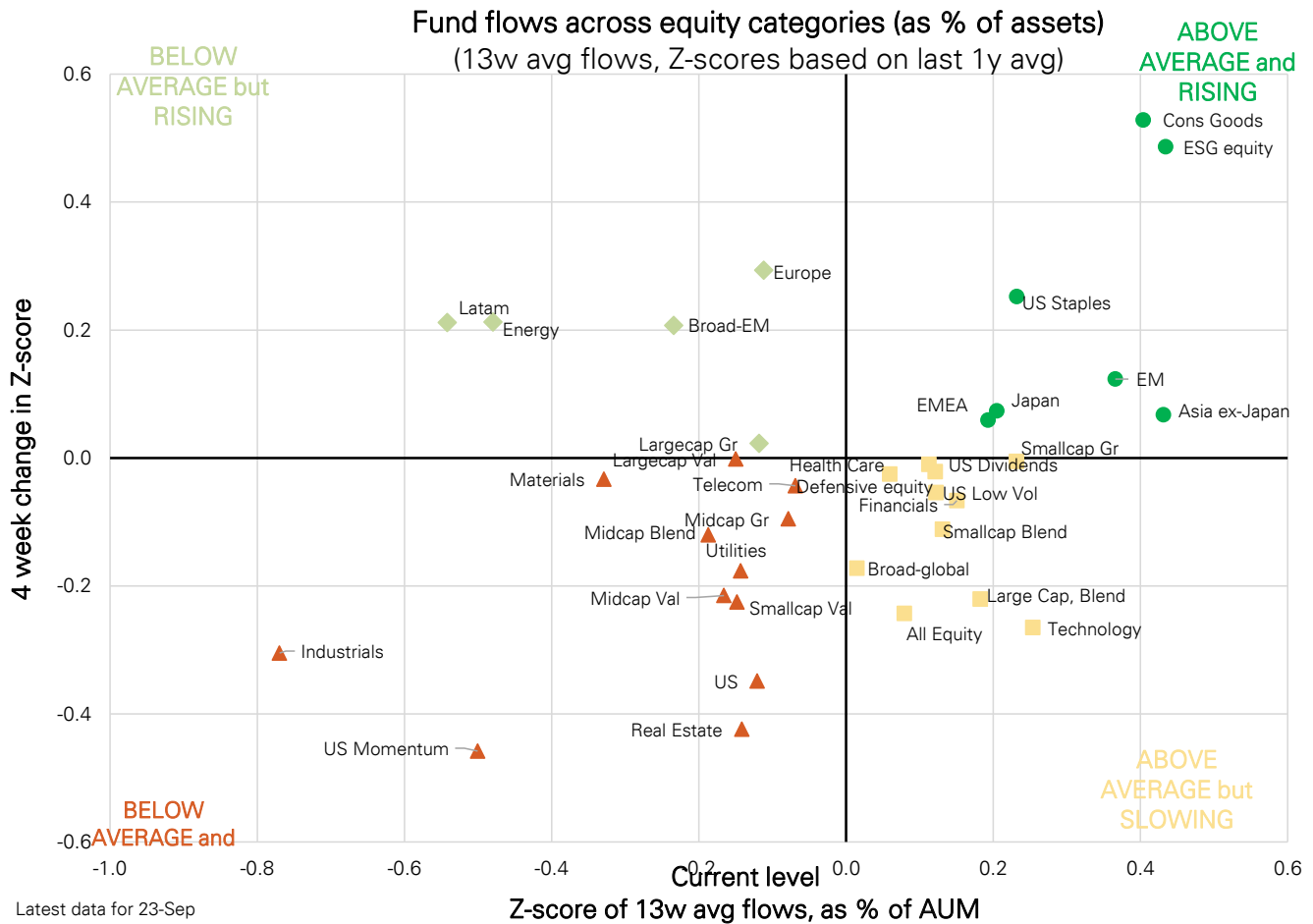


Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



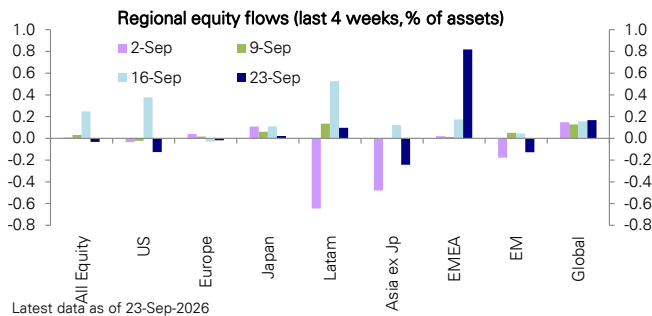
Equity Fund Flows

Figure 83: Recent trends in fund flows across equity fund categories



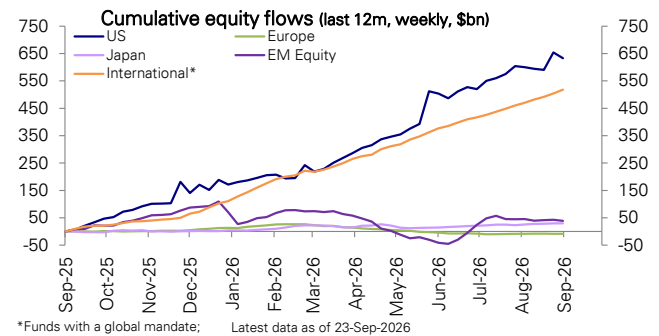
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 84: Regional equity fund flows last 4 weeks



Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 85: Equity flows across regions

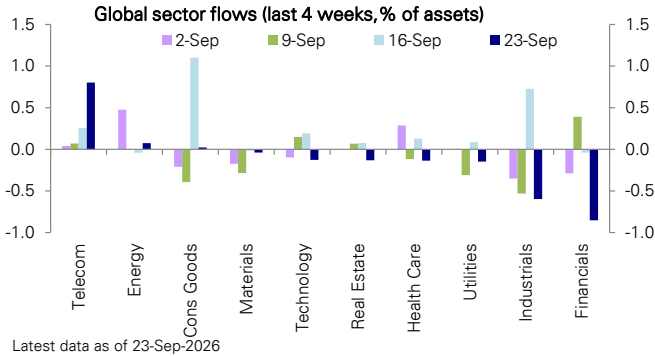


Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



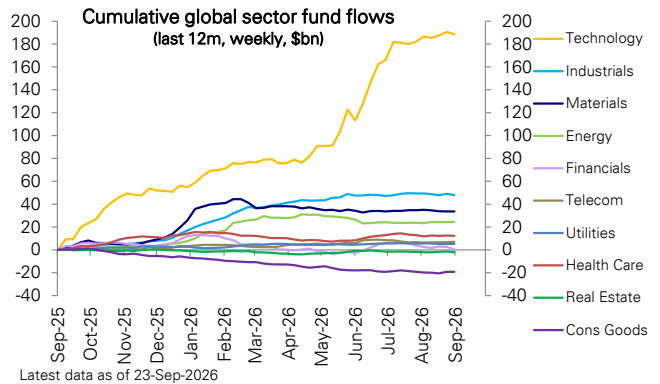
Investor Positioning and Flows

Figure 86: Sector fund flows last 4 weeks



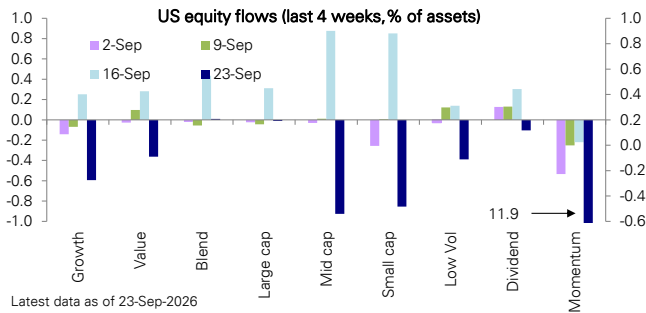
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 87: Sector fund flows



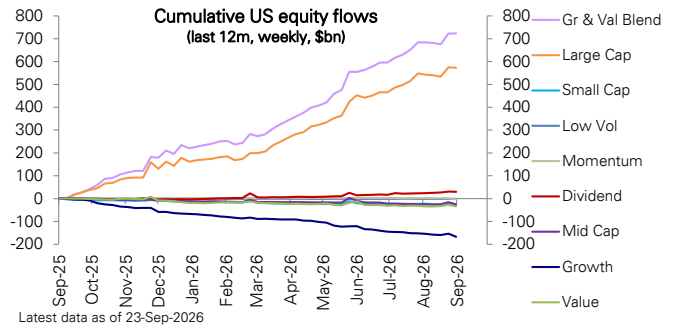
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 88: US equity flows into thematic funds last 4 weeks



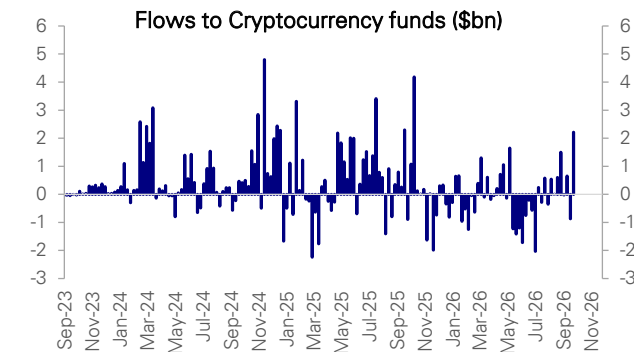
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 89: US equity flows into thematic funds



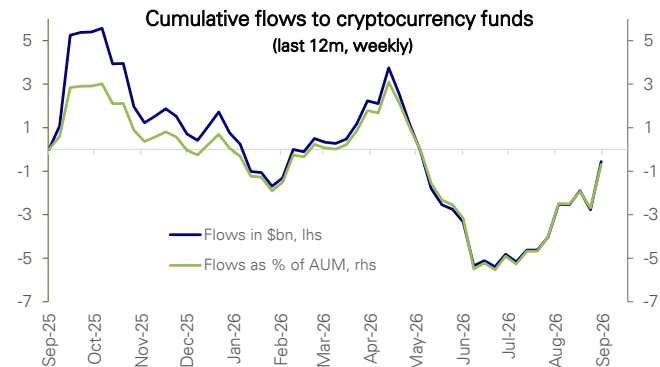
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 90: Weekly flows into cryptocurrency funds



Source : EPFR, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 91: Cumulative flows into cryptocurrency funds



Source : EPFR, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



Bond Fund Flows

Figure 92: Recent trends in fund flows across bond fund categories

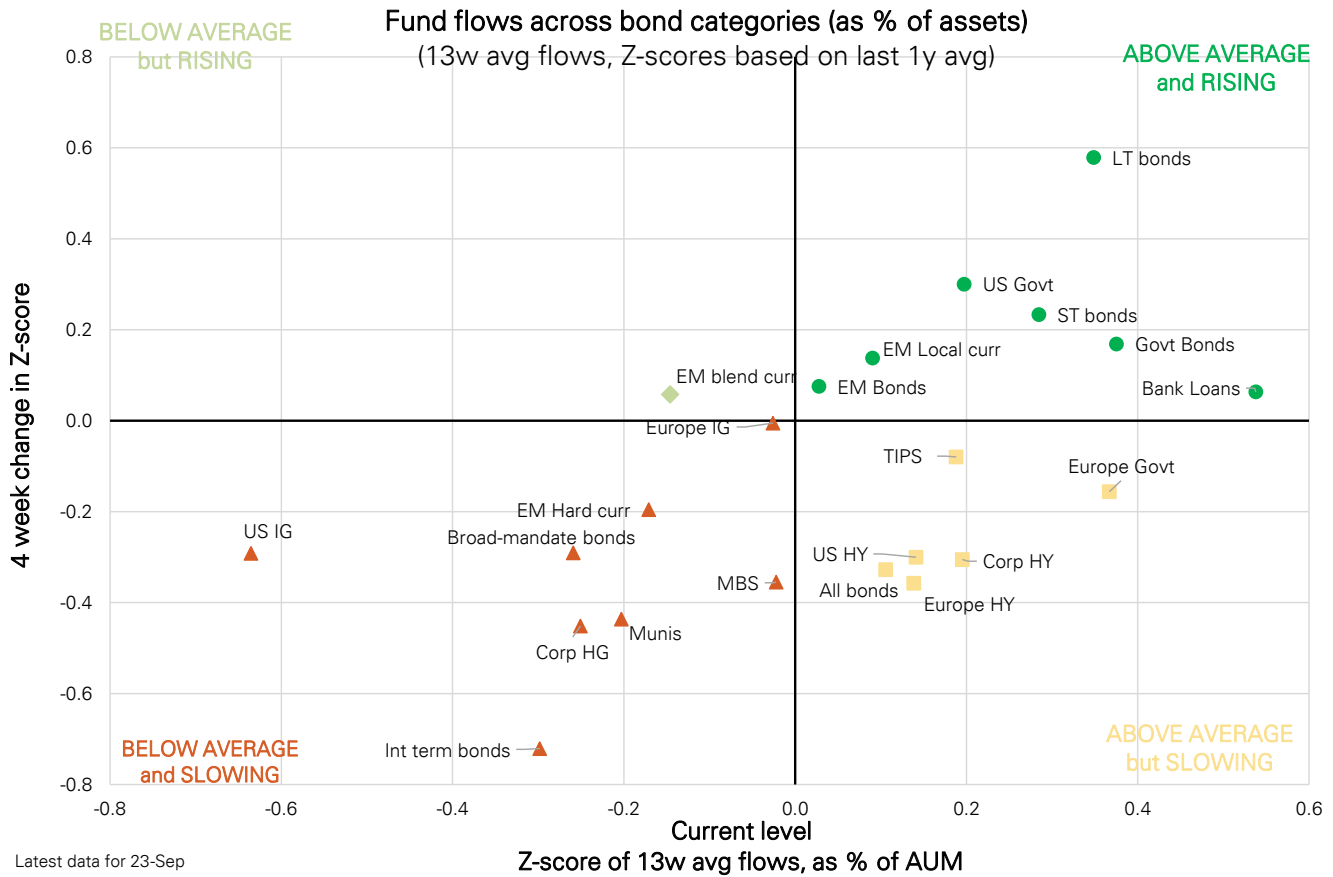


Figure 93: Bond fund flows by category last 4 weeks

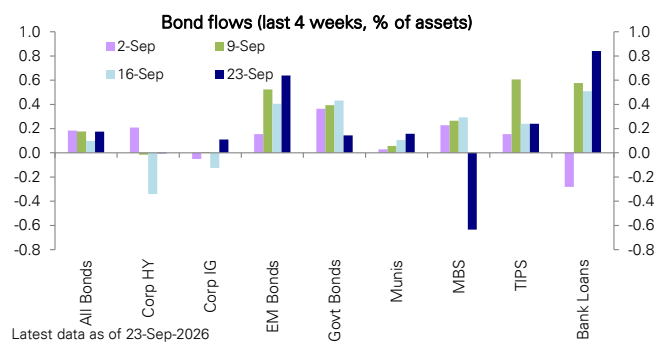
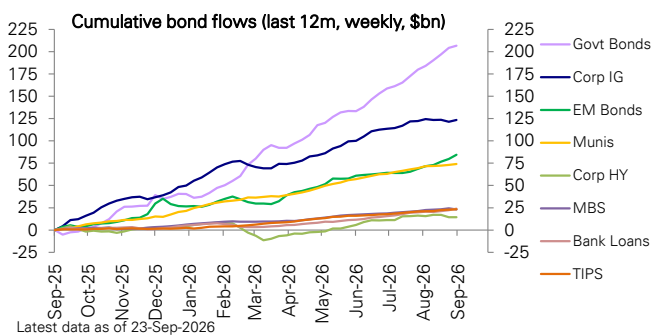


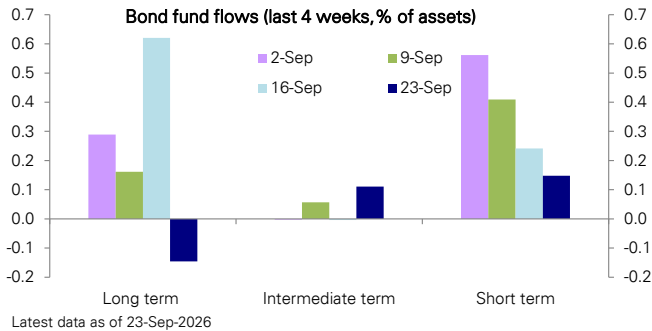
Figure 94: Bond flows by category





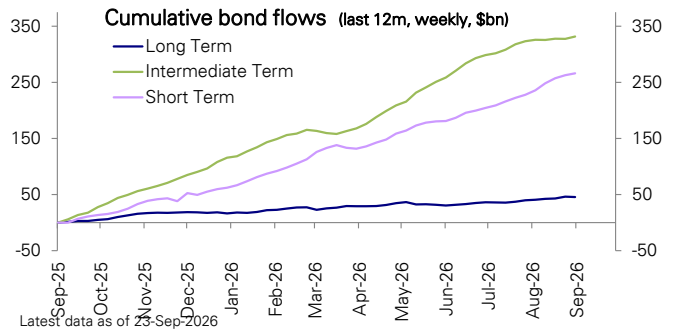
Investor Positioning and Flows

Figure 95: Bond fund flows by maturity last 4 weeks



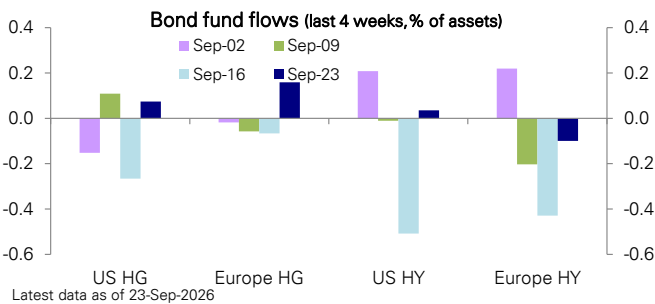
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 96: Bond fund flows by maturity



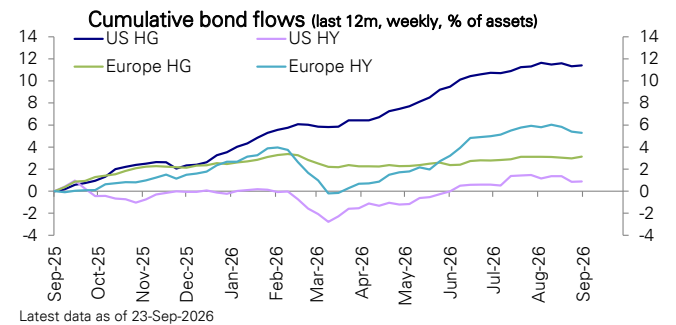
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 97: Credit fund flows to US and Europe last 4 weeks



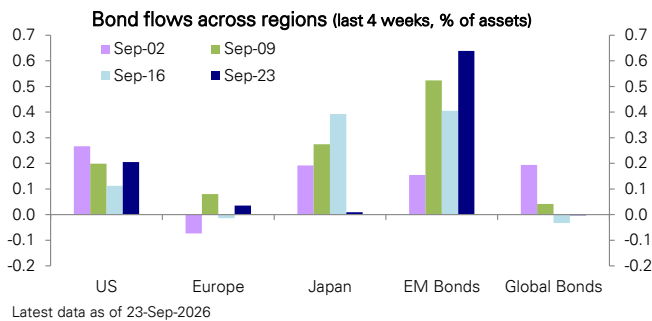
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 98: Credit fund flows to US and Europe



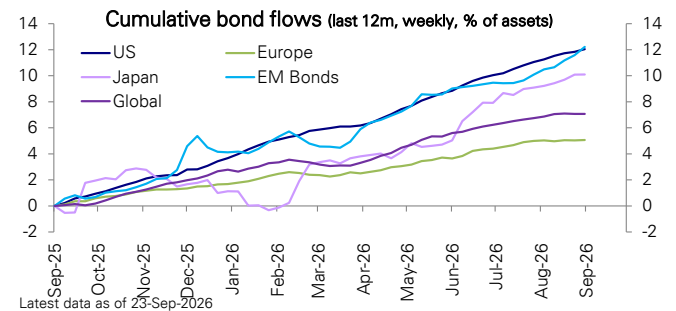
Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 99: Bond fund flows across regions last 4 weeks



Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 100: Bond fund flows across regions

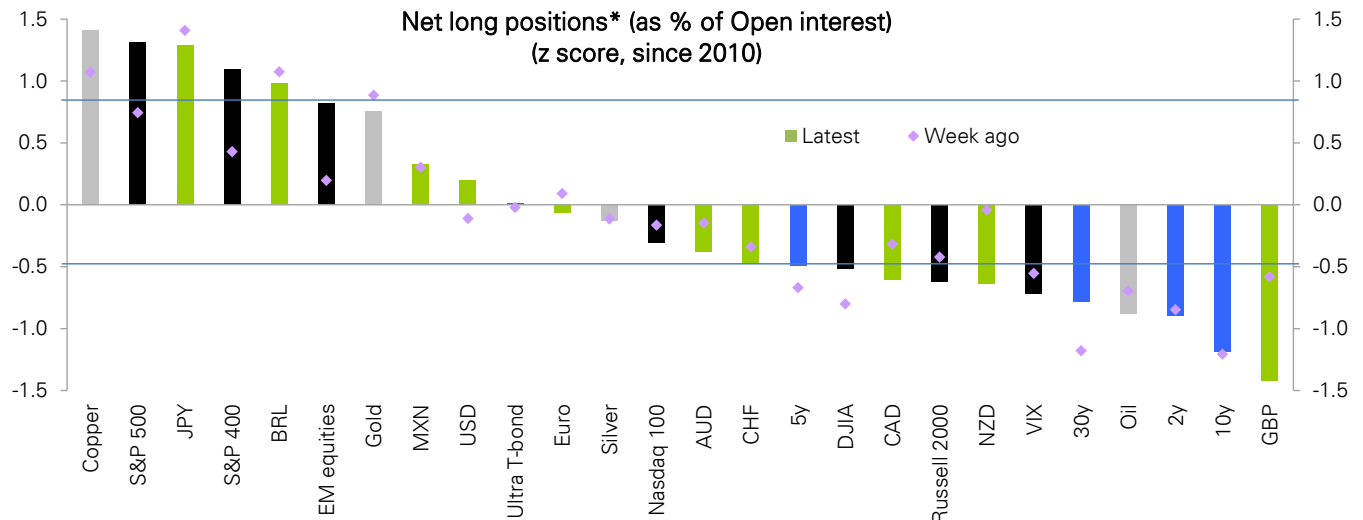


Source : EPFR, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



Cross-Asset Futures Positioning

Figure 101: Cross-asset futures positioning

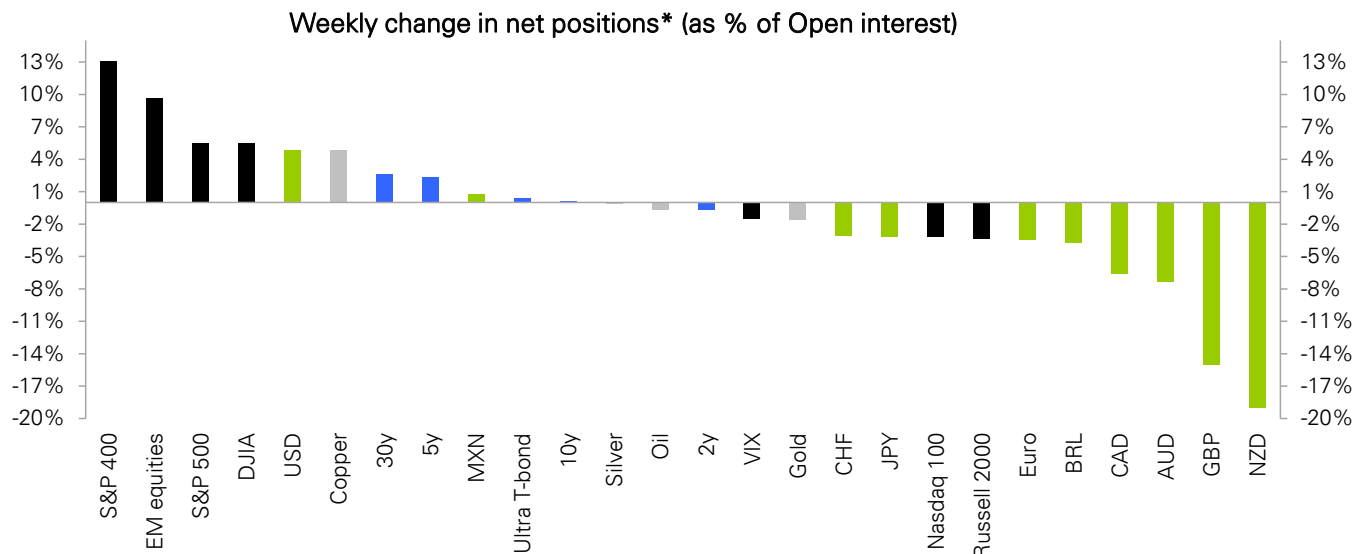


*Non commercial positions in FX and bonds; (Asset managers + Lev funds) in equities; Managed Money in commodities

Positioning data as of 22 Sep 2026

Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 102: Week-over-week changes in futures positioning



*Non commercial positions in FX and bonds; (Asset managers + Lev funds) in equities; Managed Money in commodities

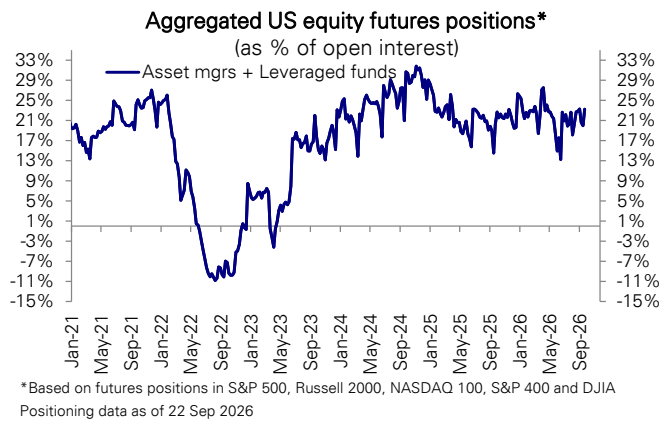
Positioning data as of 22 Sep 2026

Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



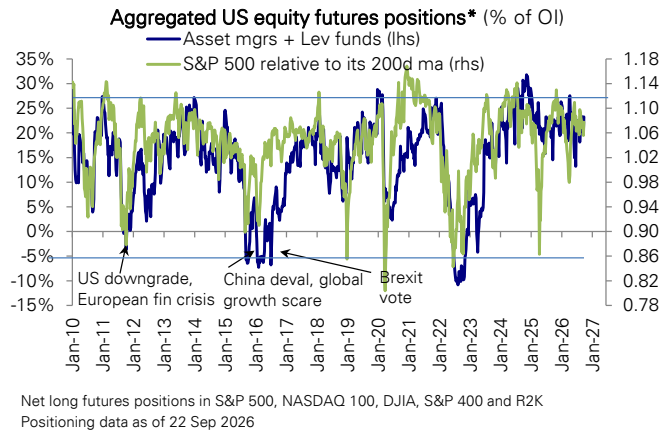
Equity Futures Positioning

Figure 103: Aggregate US equity futures positioning



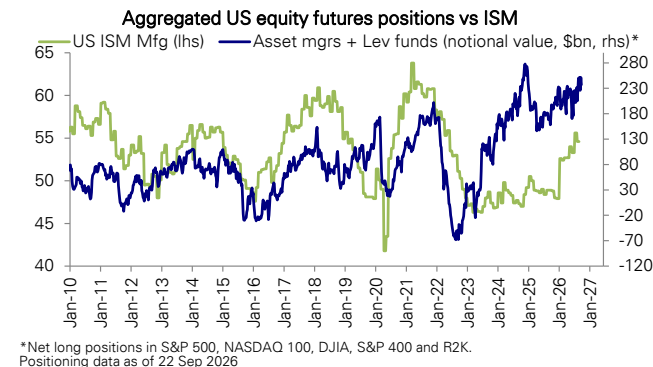
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 104: Aggregate US equity futures and S&P 500 ratio to its 200d ma



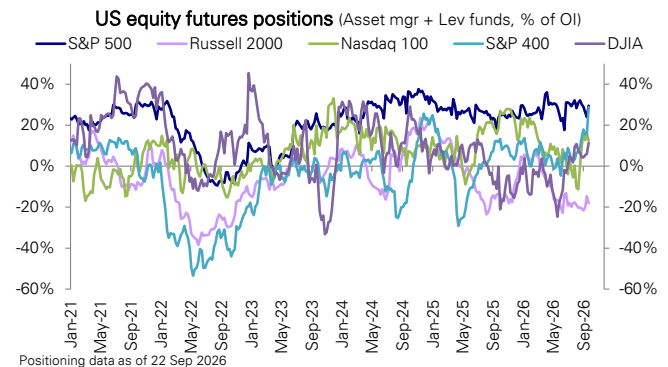
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 105: Aggregate US equity futures and ISM Manufacturing



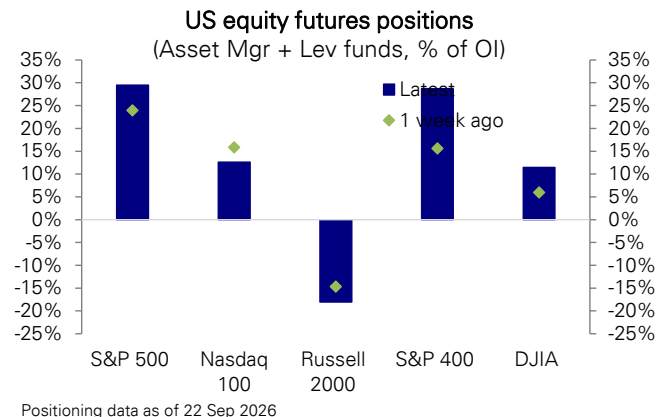
Source : ISM, CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 106: US equity futures positioning



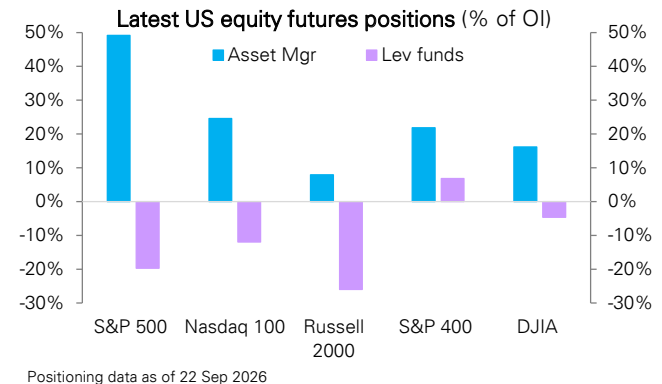
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 107: Current US equity futures positioning



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

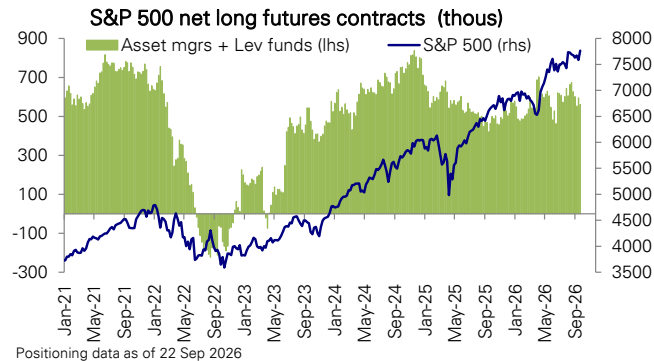
Figure 108: US equity futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

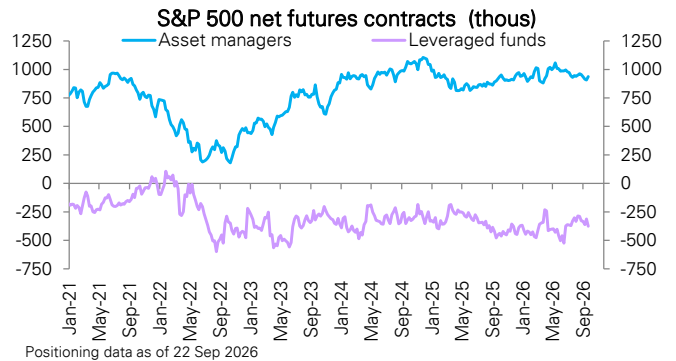


Figure 109: S&P 500 futures positioning



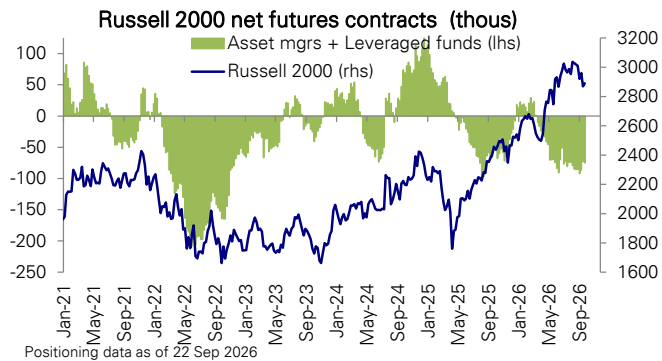
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 110: S&P 500 futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



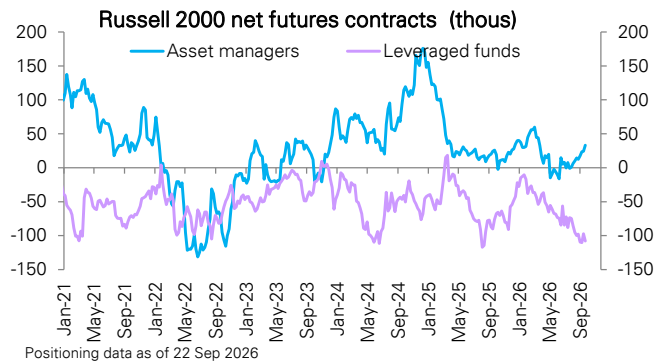
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 111: Russell 2000 futures positioning



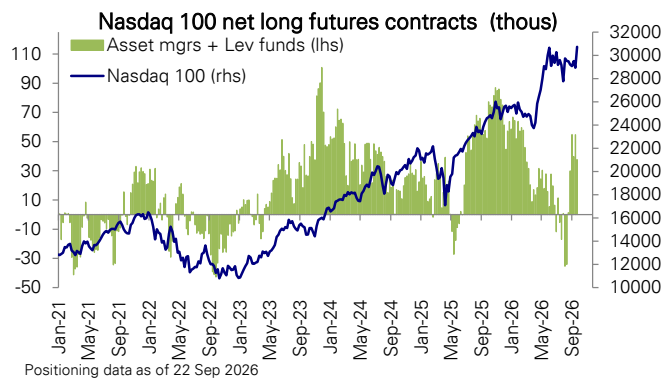
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 112: Russell 2000 futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



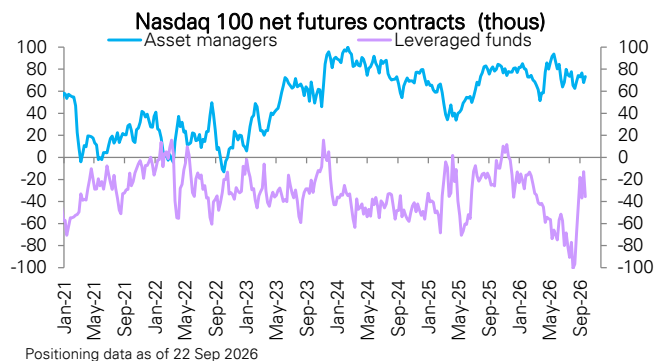
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 113: Nasdaq 100 futures positioning



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

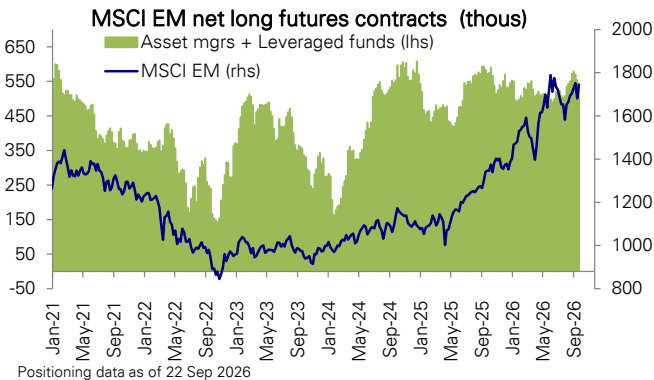
Figure 114: Nasdaq 100 futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

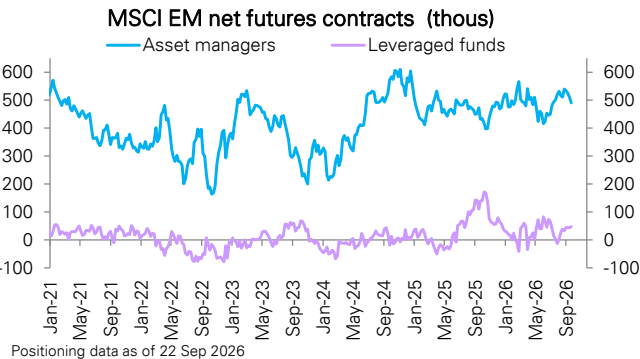


Figure 115: EM equity futures positioning



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 116: EM equity futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds

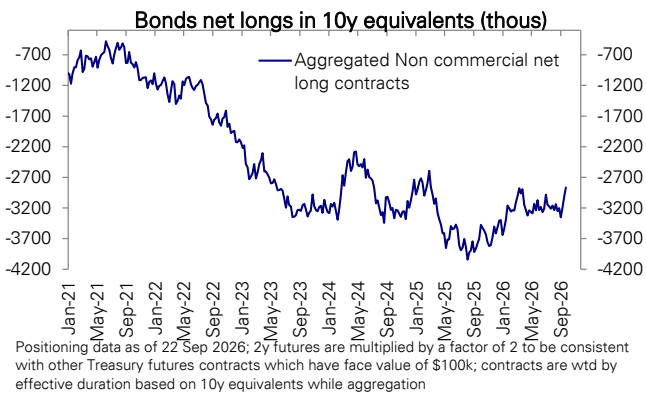


Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



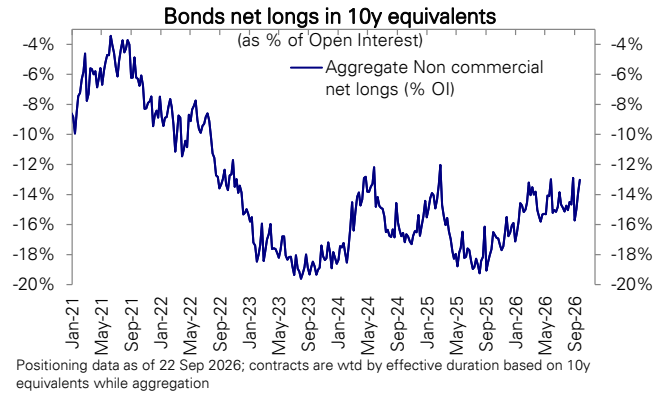
Bond Futures Positioning

Figure 117: Aggregate bond futures positioning in thousand contracts



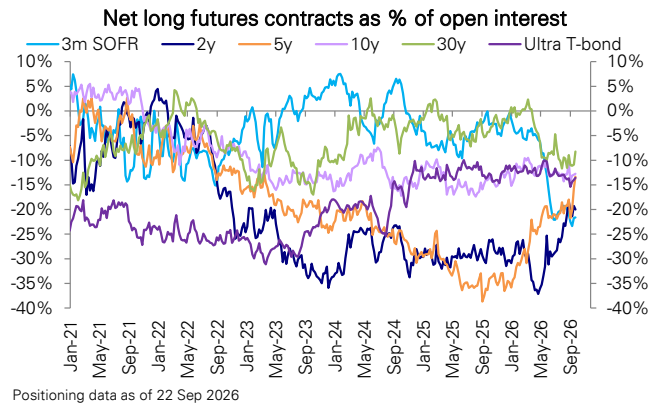
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 118: Aggregate bond futures positioning in % of open interest terms



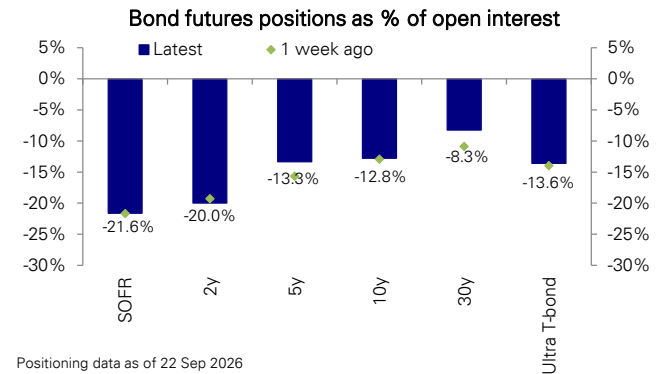
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 119: Bond futures positioning by maturity



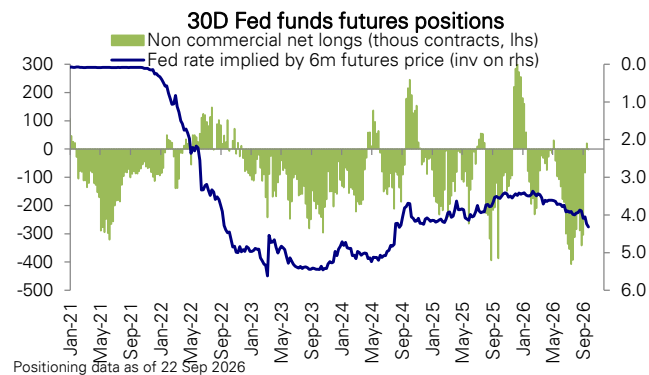
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 120: Bond futures positioning by maturity



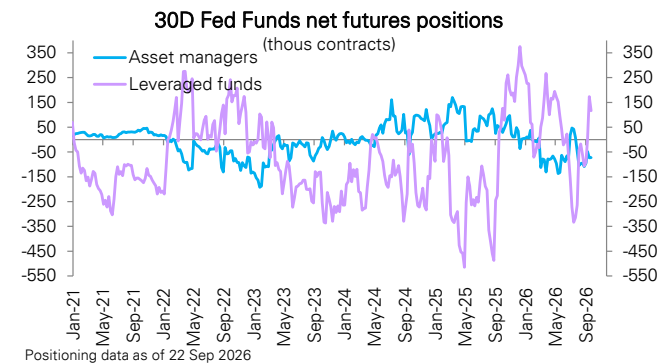
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 121: 30d Fed Fund futures positioning



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

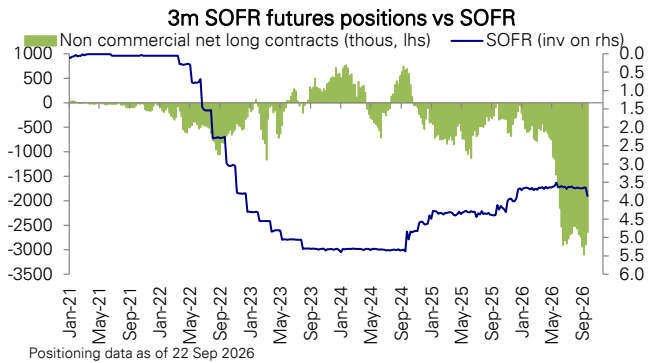
Figure 122: 30d Fed Fund futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

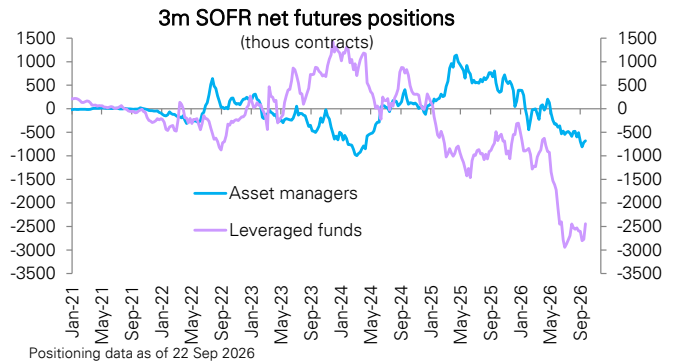


Figure 123: SOFR futures positioning



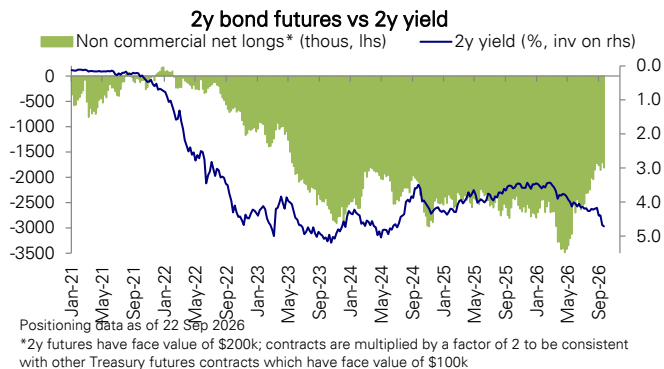
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 124: SOFR futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



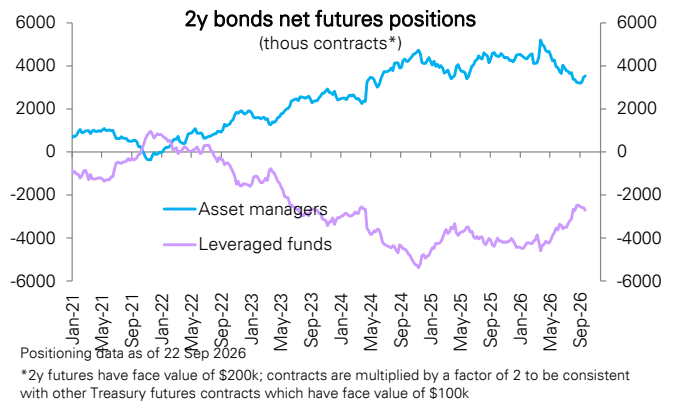
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 125: 2y Treasury notes futures positioning



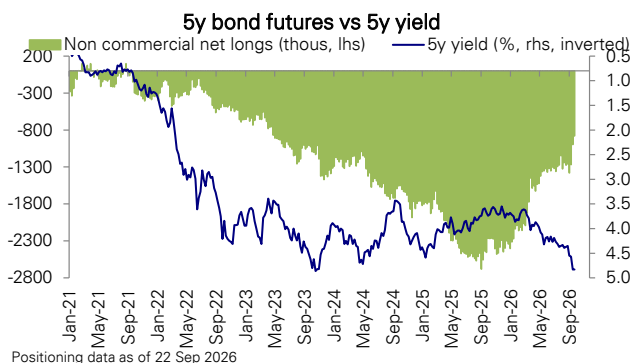
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 126: 2y Treasury notes futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



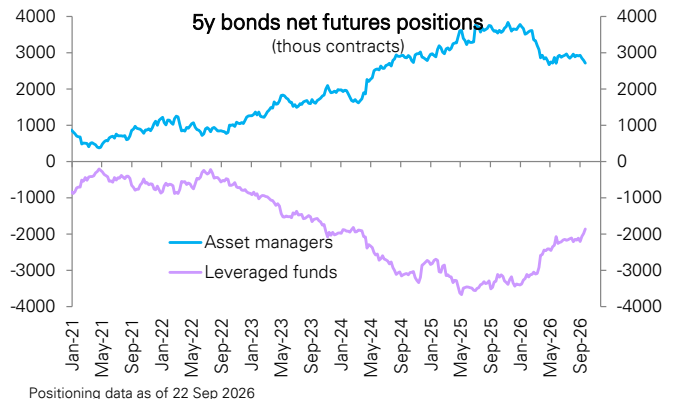
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 127: 5y Treasury notes futures positioning



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

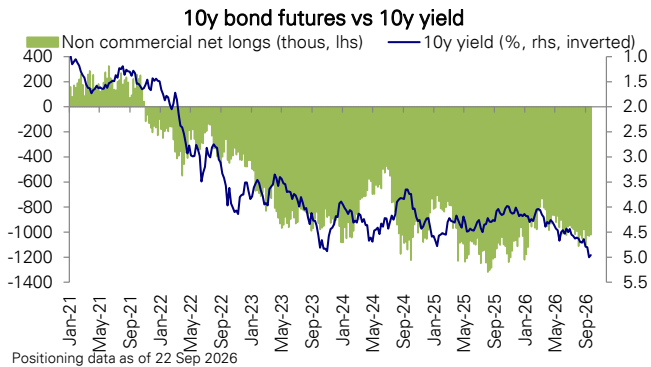
Figure 128: 5y Treasury notes futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

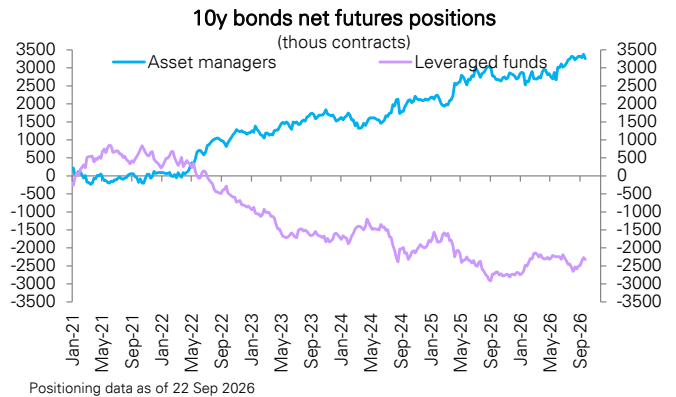


Figure 129: 10y Treasury notes futures positioning



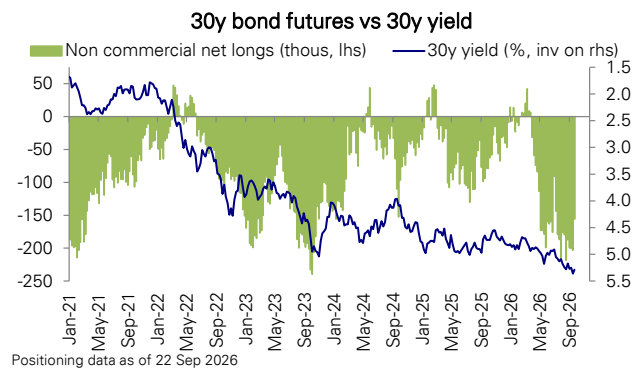
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 130: 10y Treasury notes futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



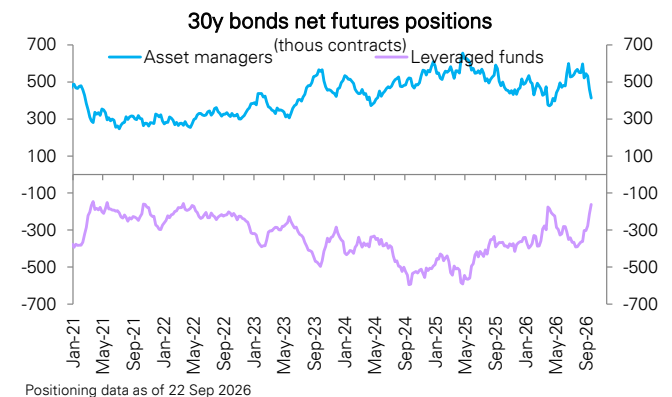
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 131: 15-25y Treasury bonds futures positioning



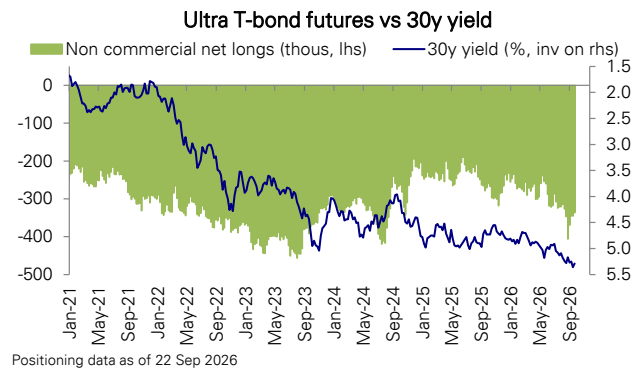
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 132: 15-25y Treasury bonds futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



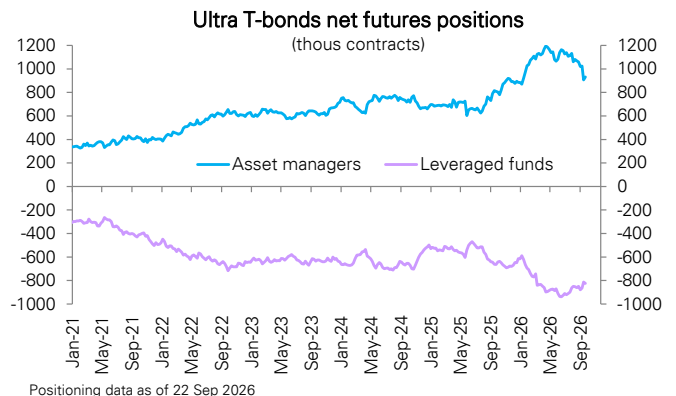
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 133: 25y+ Treasury bonds futures positioning



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 134: 25y+ Treasury bonds futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds

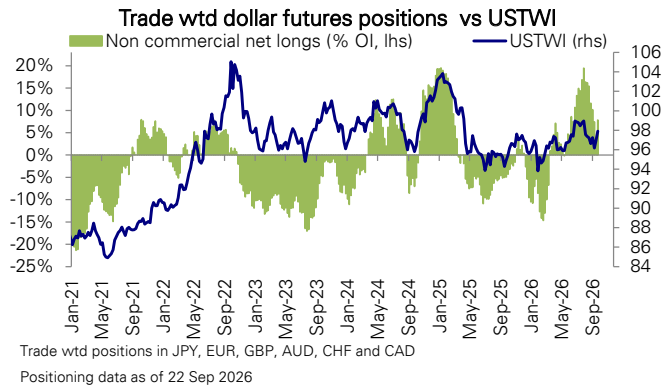


Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



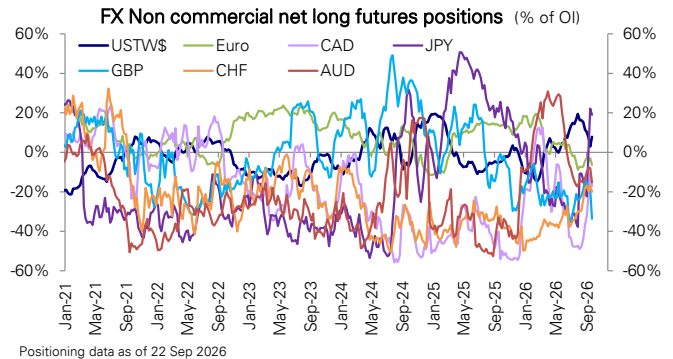
FX Futures Positioning

Figure 135: US trade-weighted dollar positioning



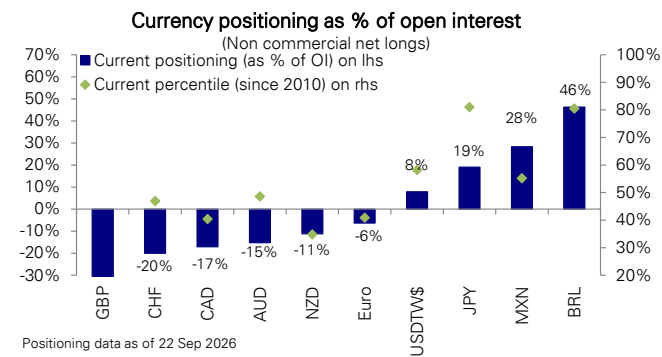
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 136: Major currency futures positioning



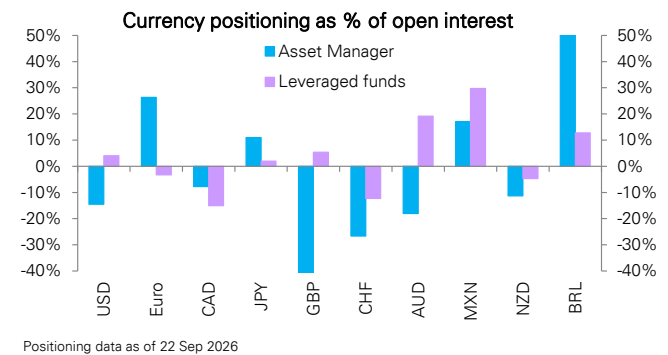
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 137: Currency futures positioning



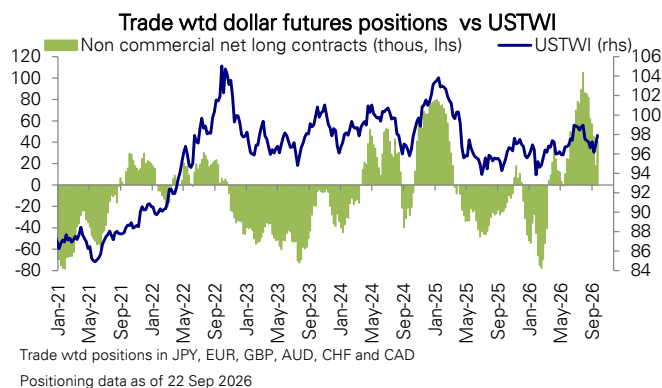
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 138: Currency futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



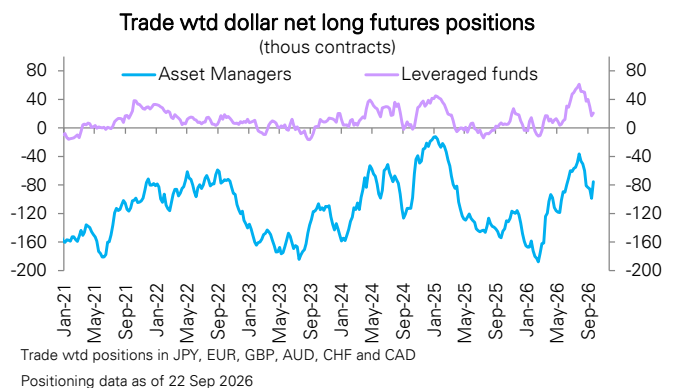
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 139: US trade-weighted dollar positioning



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

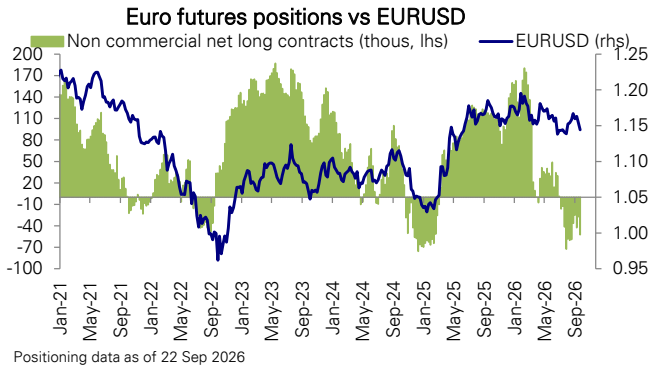
Figure 140: US trade-weighted dollar positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

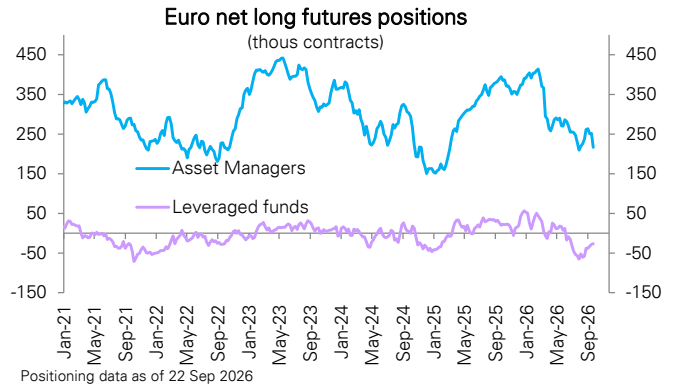


Figure 141: Euro futures positions



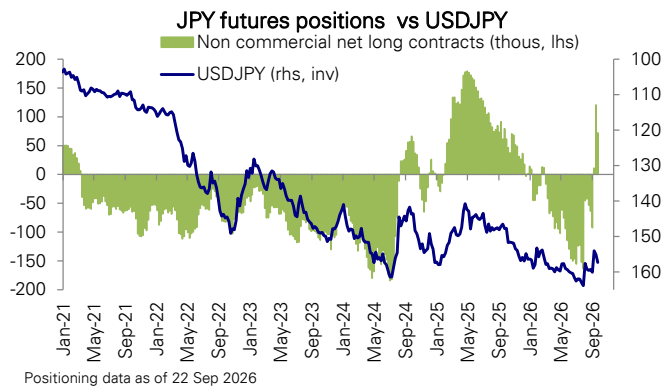
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 142: Euro futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



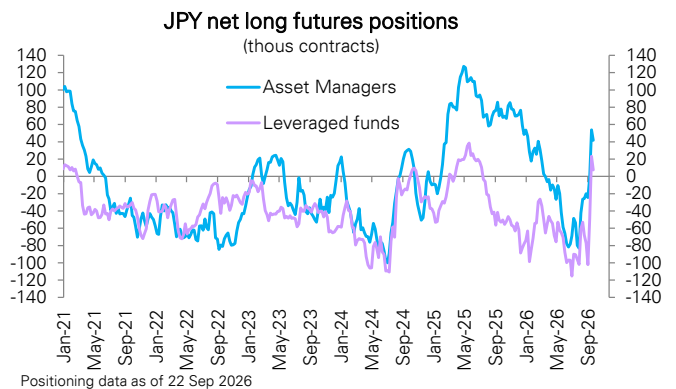
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 143: Yen futures positions



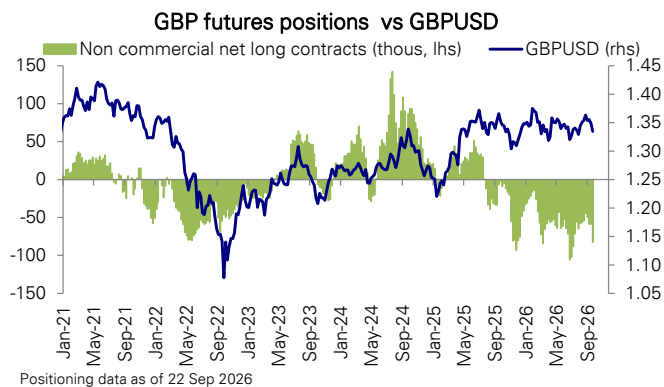
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 144: Yen futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



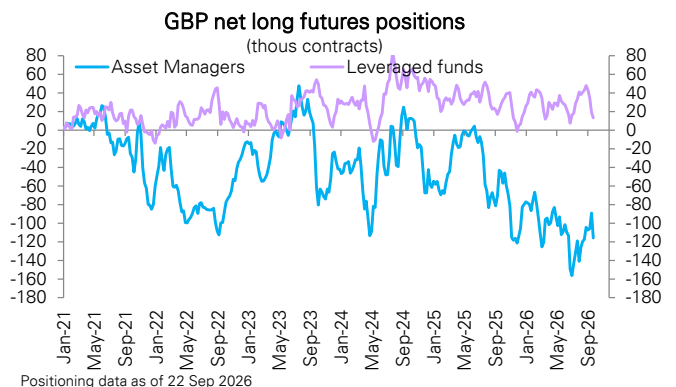
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 145: Sterling futures positions



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

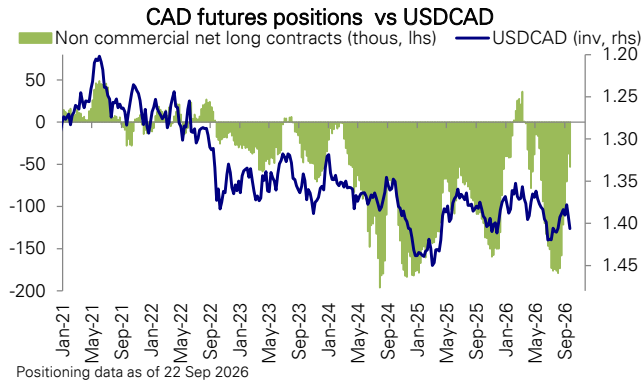
Figure 146: Sterling futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

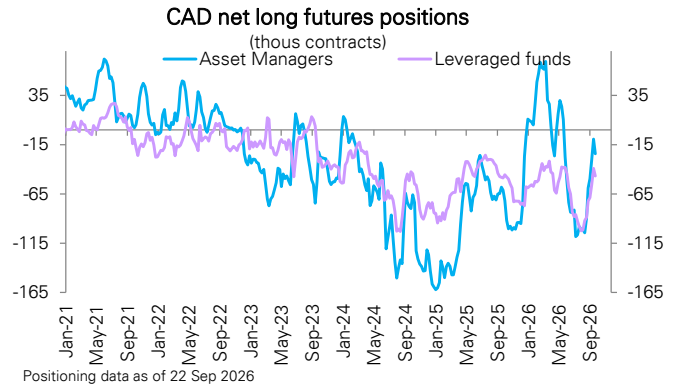


Figure 147: Canadian dollar futures positions



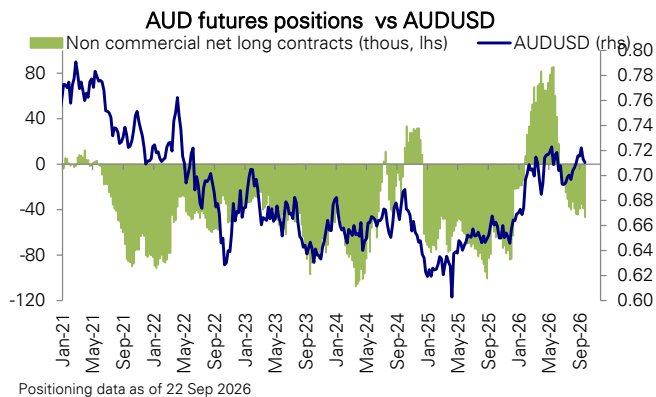
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 148: Canadian dollar futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



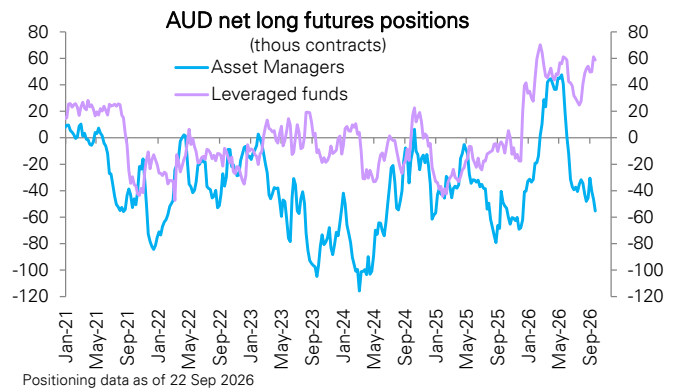
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 149: Aussie dollar futures positions



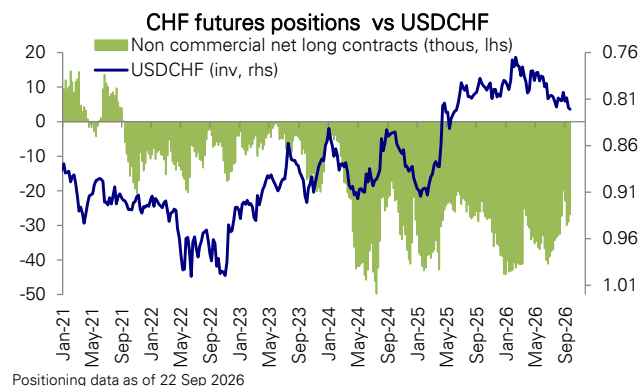
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 150: Aussie dollar futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



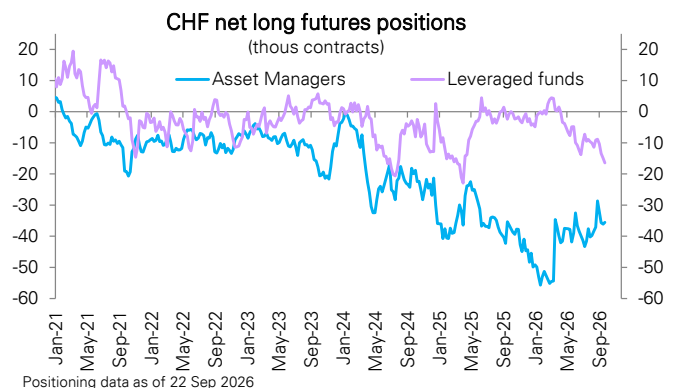
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 151: Swiss franc futures positions



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

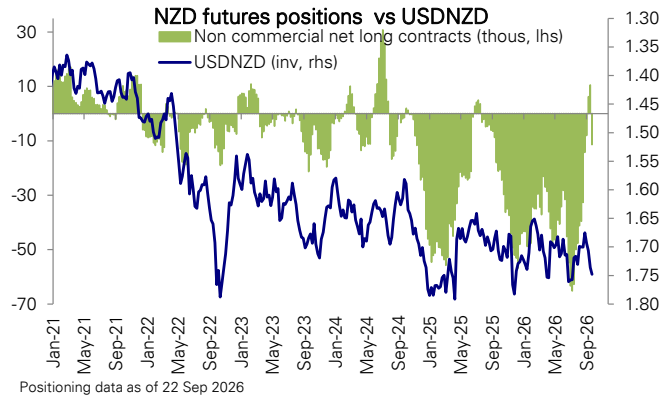
Figure 152: Swiss franc futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

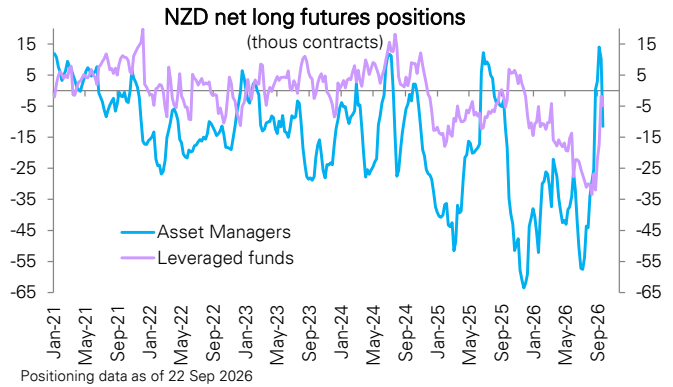


Figure 153: New Zealand dollar futures positions



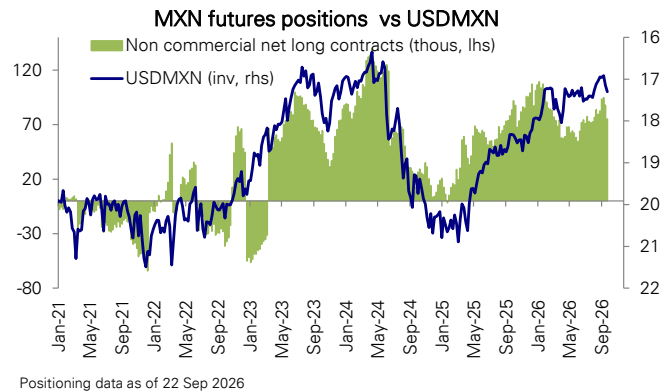
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 154: New Zealand dollar futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



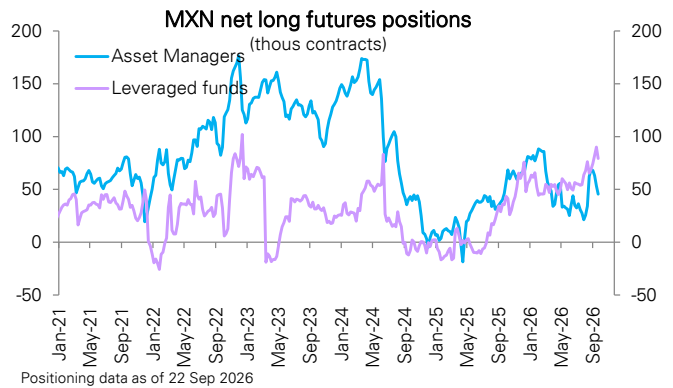
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 155: Mexican peso futures positions



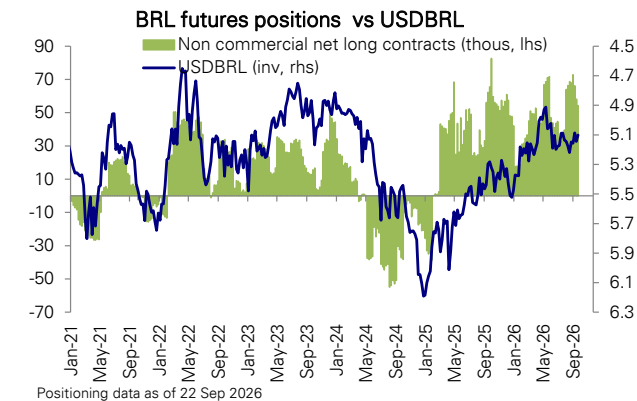
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 156: Mexican peso futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds



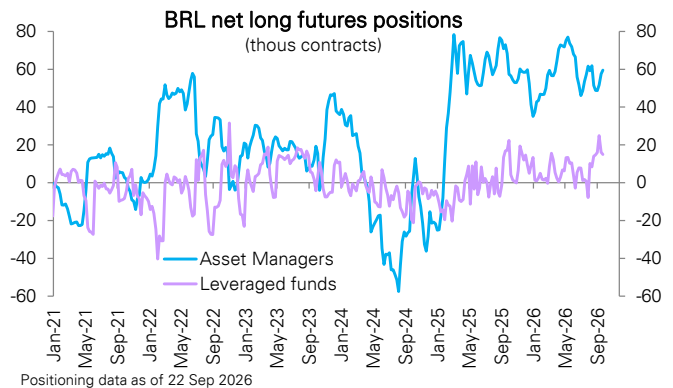
Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 157: Brazilian real futures positions



Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 158: Brazilian real futures positioning by asset managers and leveraged funds

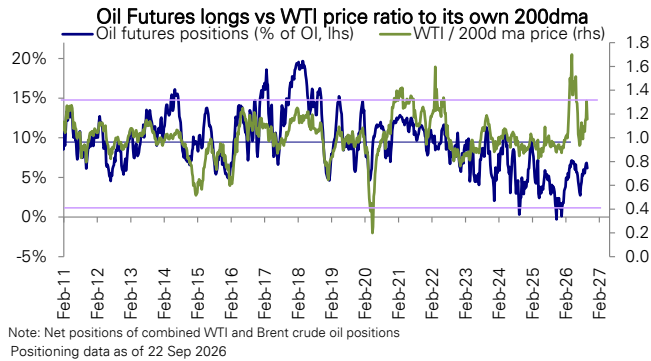


Source : CFTC, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



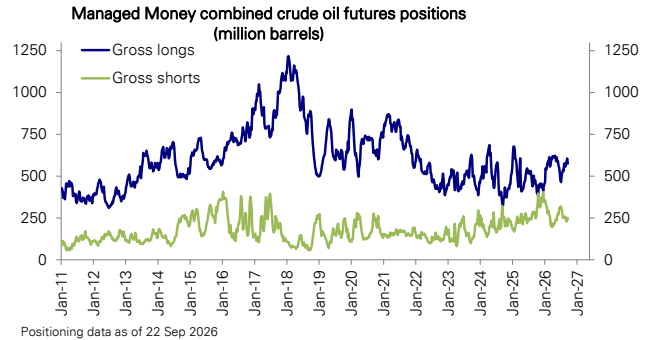
Commodity Futures Positioning

Figure 159: Oil futures positioning



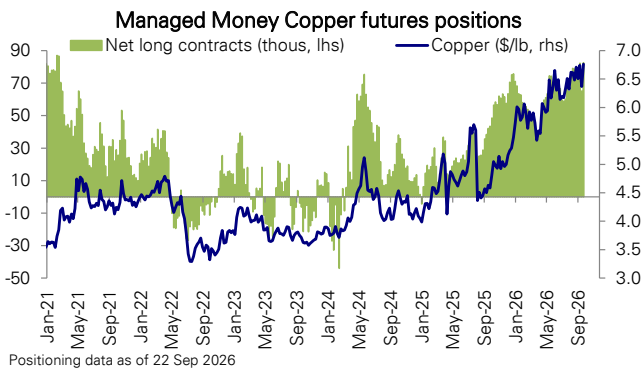
Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 160: Oil futures gross longs and shorts



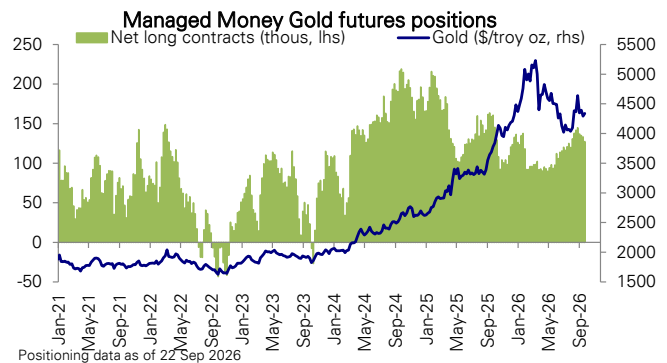
Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 161: Copper futures positioning



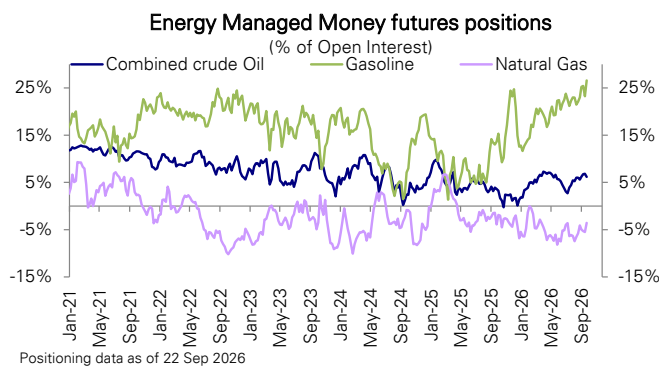
Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 162: Gold futures positioning



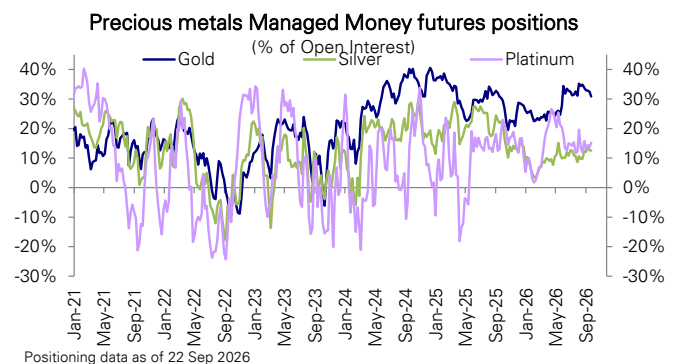
Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Haver Analytics, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 163: Energy futures positioning



Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

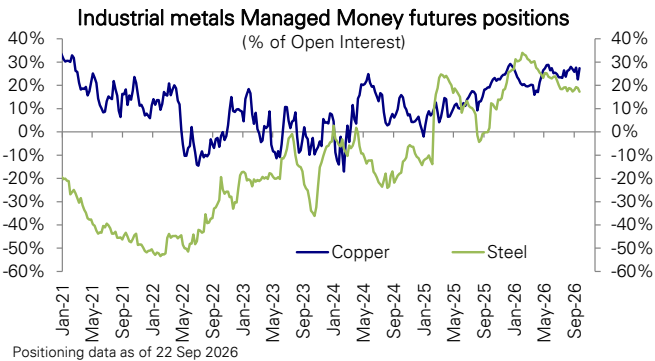
Figure 164: Precious metals futures positioning



Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

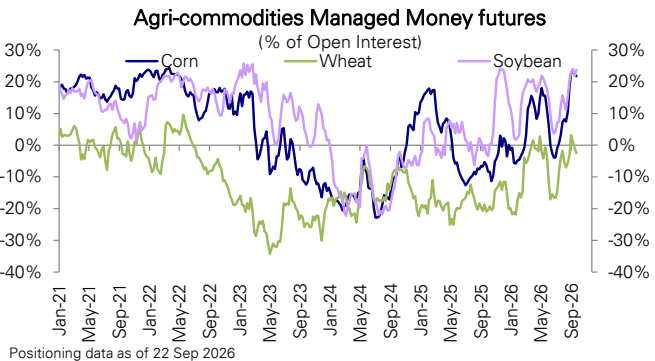


Figure 165: Industrial metals futures positioning



Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 166: Agri commodities futures positioning

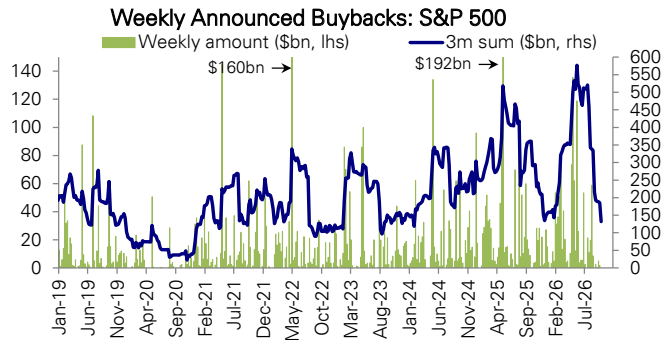


Source : CFTC, Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



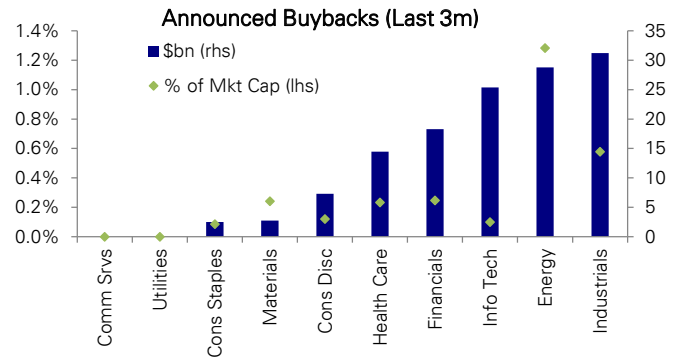
Buybacks Tracker

Figure 167: S&P 500 weekly announced buybacks



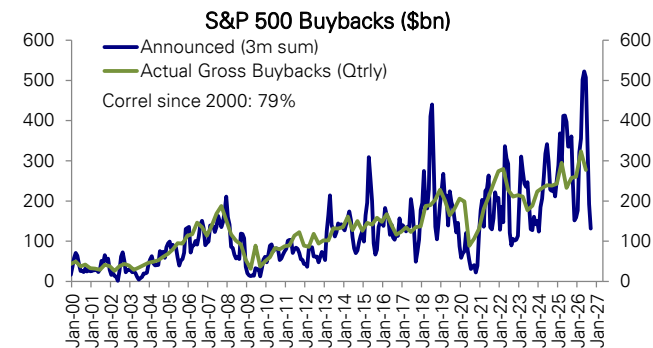
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 168: S&P 500 sectors announced buybacks



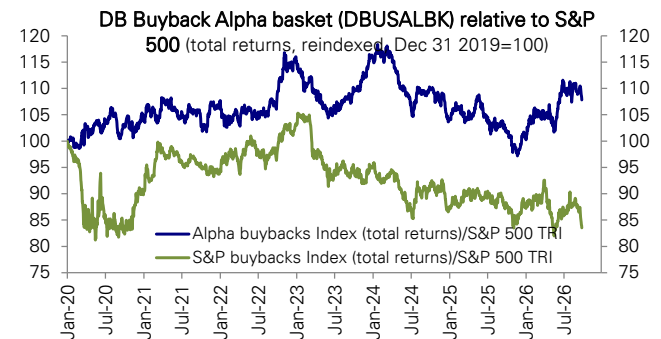
Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 169: S&P 500 announced and actual buybacks



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation

Figure 170: Buyback baskets performance



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank Asset Allocation



Appendix

Aggregate Equity Positioning Indicator

- Our measure of aggregate equity positioning is a weighted average of Z-scores across several positioning indicators. The indicator weights are based on the explanatory power of each variable in a regression with movements in the S&P 500.

Below is the list of indicators used in the aggregate positioning indicator

- **Vol-control funds equity allocation (Systematic).** Vol funds total equity allocation tries to mimic the equity rebalancing behavior of a sample of 25 Vol funds following a constant target volatility strategy. More details can be found in the report '[Derivatives Spotlight: Vol Control Products Disentangled: A Driver of Low-to-High Vol Transitions – 24 Aug 2016](#)'
- **CTAs equity weight (Systematic).** These are model-based portfolio weights, and take into account for each asset class the momentum trend signal, volatility, and cross asset correlations. The model is designed to follow movements in CTA benchmark indices.
- **Risk-parity funds equity portfolio weight (Systematic).** These are our model-based portfolio weights calculated to balance the risk contribution across different asset classes (equities, bonds, commodities), using volatility and cross asset correlations. The model is designed to follow movements in risk parity benchmark indices.
- **Equity futures (Systematic/Discretionary).** Aggregate net long futures (long minus short contracts) for Asset managers and Leveraged funds in the S&P 500, Nasdaq 100, Russell 2000, S&P 400 and DJIA index, taken as a percentage of their open interest. Data from CFTC's Traders in Financial Futures report.
- **Call/Put volume ratio (Discretionary).** Ratio of total call volume to put volume across single stocks, indices and ETPs. Data from the Chicago Board Options Exchange.
- **S&P 500 3m option skew (Discretionary).** S&P 500 options skew (90%-110% moneyness implied volatility spread, 3-month maturity) from Bloomberg. Indicator is negatively correlated with the S&P 500, and the z-score values are multiplied by -1 before inclusion in the composite.
- **Investor Bull minus Bear spread (Discretionary).** Investor sentiment (Bull minus Bear spread) from the AAI Investor Sentiment Survey.
- **Cash equity median shorts (Discretionary).** Median of Russell 3000 universe shorted shares, taken as % of outstanding shares. Indicator is negatively correlated with the S&P 500, and the z-score values are multiplied by -1 before inclusion in the composite.
- **ETFs short interest (Discretionary).** Aggregate short interest (price*shorted shares) of more than 100 largest equity ETFs in the US, taken as % of overall Russell 3000 market cap. Indicator is negatively correlated with the S&P 500, and the z-score values are multiplied by -1 before inclusion in the composite.



- **Schwab Retail positioning index (Discretionary).** Schwab Trading Activity Index (STAX) which gauges the sentiment of retail investors.
- **MFs holdings beta (Discretionary).** The equity beta of the holdings of a sample of broad active equity mutual funds (excluding cash) taken from their quarterly 13F filings. The beta of the holdings to S&P 500 returns is calculated over a 3-year window

Sectors Equity Positioning

- As an extension of the aggregate equity positioning, the sector positioning measure is also a weighted average of Z-scores across different sector level positioning indicators. The indicator weights are based on the explanatory power of each variable in a regression with movements in the S&P 500 sectors. More details can be found in the report '[Investor Positioning and Flows - Looking Across Sectors, Jul 7 2023](#)'

Below is the list of indicators used in the large cap sector positioning measure

- **Weighted Call/Put volume ratio.** Ratio of Call volume to Put volume across stocks, weighted by their market caps and averaged out over the last one month. Data from the OCC.
- **Sector fund flows:** Fund flows to sector based ETFs and mutual funds, taken as a percentage of AUM, and averaged out for the last 4 weeks. Data from EPFR.
- **S&P 500 cash shorts as % of market cap.** S&P 500 sector short interest, taken as % of their market cap. Indicator is negatively correlated with the S&P 500 sector performance, and the z-score values are multiplied by -1 before inclusion in the composite.
- **Active MFs excess return correlation.** Rolling 3-month correlation of the excess returns of a representative sample of US blended mutual funds with S&P 500 sector excess returns (both relative to the S&P 500).
- **Analyst consensus target.** Analysts current 12-month target price for the S&P 500 sector, taken as a ratio to its 200d ma. Data from Bloomberg Finance LP.



Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

*Other information available upon request

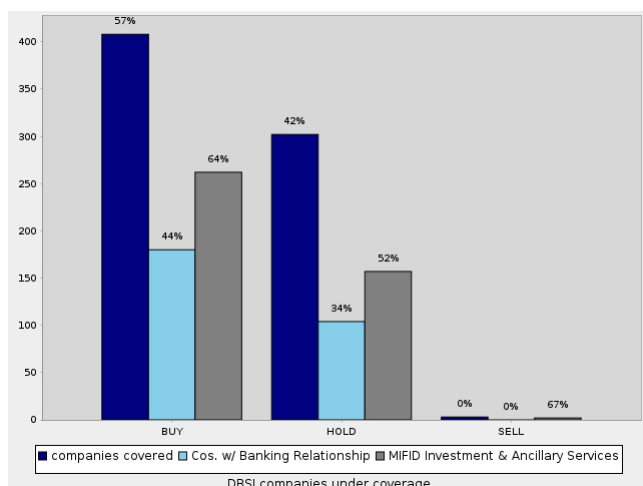
*Prices are current as of the end of the previous trading session unless otherwise indicated and are sourced from local exchanges via Reuters, Bloomberg and other vendors. Other information is sourced from Deutsche Bank, subject companies, and other sources. For disclosures pertaining to recommendations or estimates made on securities other than the primary subject of this research, please see the most recently published company report or visit our global disclosure look-up page on our website at <https://research.db.com/Research/Disclosures/EquityResearchDisclosures>. Aside from within this report, important risk and conflict disclosures can also be found at <https://research.db.com/Research/Disclosures/Disclaimer>. Investors are strongly encouraged to review this information before investing.

Analyst Certification

The views expressed in this report accurately reflect the personal views of the undersigned lead analyst(s). In addition, the undersigned lead analyst(s) has not and will not receive any compensation for providing a specific recommendation or view in this report. Parag Thatte, Binky Chadha, Karthik Prabhu, Dag Workayehu.



Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships



Equity Rating and Dispersion Key

The Equity Rating Dispersion Chart depicts the following:

The proportion of recommendations that are rated "buy", "sell" and "hold" over the previous 12 months. This is shown for securities issued in the stated region e.g. "Europe Universe". See rating definitions below. This is represented by the "Companies Covered" bars in the chart. The percentage value displayed above the bar is the proportion as a percentage. E.g. 50% above the "buy" / "Companies Covered" bar means that 50% of DB's equity research covered companies over the past 12 months have a "buy" rating.

Next to each of the three respective bars showing the proportion of "buy", "sell" and "hold" recommendations we provide two additional bars to show:

- The proportion of "buy", "sell" or "hold" recommendations where Deutsche Bank and or/Affiliates provided MIFID Investment or Ancillary Services in the past 12 months. This is represented in the "MIFID Investment and Ancillary Services" bar. The percentage value displayed above the bar shows the proportion of Companies Covered with the given rating where DB has also provided MIFID Investment and Ancillary Services in the past 12 months. E.g. 50% above the "Cos. w/ MIFID Investment and Ancillary Services" bar means 50% of the Companies Covered with the rating stated have also received MIFID Investment and Ancillary Services from DB.

- The proportion of "buy" (or "sell" or "hold") recommendations where Deutsche Bank and or/Affiliates has provided Investment Banking services in the past 12 months for which it has received compensation. The percentage value displayed above the bar shows the proportion of Companies Covered with the stated rating where DB has also provided Investment Banking services in the past 12 months. E.g. 50% above the "Cos. w/ Investment Banking relationship" bar means 50% of the Companies Covered with the rating stated also have an Investment Banking Relationship with DB.

Buy: Based on a current 12- month view of TSR, we recommend that investors buy the stock.

Sell: Based on a current 12-month view of TSR, we recommend that investors sell the stock.

Hold: We take a neutral view on the stock 12-months out and, based on this time horizon, do not recommend either a Buy or Sell.

TSR = Total Shareholder Return. Percentage change in share price from current price to projected target price plus projected dividend yield

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Additional Information

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